Career counseling strategies

Practical handbook

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Career counselling strategies

- a practical handbook -

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INTRODUCTION

This Handbook presents recent theories that have attempted to explain the phenomenon of career choice. Most of the theories suggest that certain personal characteristics and elements of environment expose the person to certain learning experiences. Individual's belief system is emerging from these learning experiences. The two major paradigms for career interventions in the 21st century were vocational guidance and career education. Vocational guidance remains a psychology of fixed characteristics and types that can be objectified by tests and then matched to occupations that offer stable long tenure. Career education remains a predictable trajectory of development tasks that can be alleviated by teaching individuals mature attitudes and skills that prepare them to unfold careers in different organizations. Matching the vocational guidance

and career preparation through education may not adequately address the design life of the individuals' needs in the information society. The Chaos Theory of Careers (Pryor and Bright; 2011) provides an overview of the common models in career choice and guidance and presents the limitations of these theories in today's complex, ever changing and unpredictable world. The Chaos Theory of Careers (CTC) helps reduce clients' fears of failing by exploring the reasons behind their fears and increases clients' comfort with uncertainties by helping them reframe mistakes and failures as a necessary part of reality and an opportunity for learning.

It is recognized that counselling and career guidance can contribute to the maximum development of the professional potential of people in accordance with their aspirations and abilities, reducing academic dropout, an optimal transition of young people between different

educational levels, increasing participation in education, developing social inclusion and equity in education or increasing employability by facilitating direct access.

The scope of the present Handbook is on narrative career counselling's contribution in offering a meaningful experience for people accessing career guidance services. In order to depict the potential of narrative career counselling, the storytelling approach is provided as a powerful technique for crafting client's self identities in contextually anchored ways.

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HIGHLIGHTS IN CAREER DEVELOPMENT THEORIES

There are a number of theories that have attempted to explain the phenomenon of career choice. Psychological theories argue that this decision is the result of the action of personal factors (interests, skills, personal values) and some factors related to the environment in which the person lives (labour market requirements, analysis of consumer's job). One of the most accepted theories in this category argues that certain personal characteristics and elements of environment expose the person to certain learning experiences. Individual's belief system is emerging from these learning experiences. Early performance in childhood will influence beliefs on the ability to perform certain tasks and the results if engaging in certain tasks. In return, these beliefs underlie human shaping professional interests. In accordance with interests, the

individual will set some goals, will act in accordance with them and, in perspective, will perform in the chosen field.

In response to these psychological theories there have emerged some sociological theories supporting that the career decision is not influenced in such a great manner by personality factors, but it is anchored in social environment. These theories suggest that the most important role is played by variables such as social class or existing opportunities in the labour market at a time. In general, graduates who want to start working are ready to accept almost anything they are offered. Preference for a certain type of occupation is not driven just by the individual aspects (skills, aspirations, interests, values), but is determined by a system of social stratification. Because of family environment and learning experiences to which he has been exposed to, the individual will occupy a certain place in society -

will be part of a specific „social layer" that will cover alternatives in making decisions about their own career. Thus, each person is closer to certain occupations and so will focus on this kind of occupations.

We cannot say which of the two theories is true. There are lots of examples to support both theories. There are many people who followed the profession of a parent or close relative, but there are also those who have chosen a different profession. What we can say for sure is that career choice is never accidental and is a complex process influenced by the decisions of both individual and social forces acting at a point on the individual. At the same time choosing a career is a process that takes place throughout life, as the individual passes through various learning situations.

An important element in choosing a career, underestimated by almost all theories is

represented by the material aspect, the income. Profession, besides satisfying spiritual source, supposedly offers livelihood. We have many examples of people around us that perform professions regarded as interesting, thrilling, doing their job with passion and earning a lot of money from it. In reality it does not always happen. Often the individual is forced to choose between pursuing a profession that is not preferred, but brings a lot of material satisfactions or a profession that is preferred, but the income is not convenient. Even if professional satisfaction is determined by the combined action of the material and spiritual benefits, people do not give the same importance to the two types of rewards.

Theories rarely explain the whole story, but good theories are able to guide clients in gathering information and filling empty spaces for a more complete image on own experience. Parsons' work and subsequent trait-factor theories are important

because these models are naturally intertwined with the historical roots of career development interventions. Research of contributors such as Parsons, Williamson, Dawis and Lofquist, emphasizes the importance of analyzing interactions between individual characteristics and work environment factors in making career decisions.

Building on the discussion about the Parsons' model and trait-factor type approaches, Super's theory provides a useful framework for conceptualizing the career development throughout life. Super suggests that the process of choosing an occupation that permits maximum self-expression occurs over time and can be summarized in four career stages:

(1) Exploration, a period of engaging in self-examination, schooling, and the study of different career options;

(2) Establishment, a period of becoming

employed and finding a niche;

(3) Maintenance, a period of holding on to one's position and up-dating skills;

(4) Disengagement, a period of phasing into retirement (Super, Thompson, & Lindeman, 1988).

His theory also recognizes various personal determinants (needs, values, skills) and situational determinants (family, employment) that influence career development. Super's theory places the work in the context of multiple roles played in life. Finally, the theory has addressed the support of people in clarifying, articulating and implementing their own concepts about their life roles. Super's theory provides a useful framework for observing general career development processes.

To develop personal and situational influences on the subject of career development, we will briefly discuss the theory of career developed by Anna

Roe and then the conceptualizations elaborated by Linda Gottfredson. Roe's theory indicates the importance of early life experiences in career development. Gottfredson's theory addresses the idea that creating gender role stereotypes influence the career aspirations of men and women (Gottfredson, 1996, 2002). Second theory provides a sociological development and career development perspective. Theory focuses primarily on career development process to the extent that it relates to the types of compromises people make in formulating their occupational aspirations.

The most complex career theory belongs to Holland, which has generated more research than any other career theory. Arguably Holland's typology provides the most useful framework for understanding and predicting individual behaviour (the general satisfaction with job performance at work and occupational stability) in the

environment. Using analysis tools Holland applies RIASEC typology to help people clarify and implement their occupational identities (Spokane, Luchetta, & Richwine, 2002).

There are cases where defective or irrational thinking prevents people to develop their careers. The cumulative effect of a variety of learning experiences can lead to varying degrees of functionality between individuals in terms of their ability to make effective career decisions. For example, when they receive adequate support and are exposed to effective role models, people often develop interests and skills that lead to satisfying career choices. Conversely, when such support is lacking and people are misinformed, they often disregard the appropriate options as it lacks confidence or adhere to beliefs („I must decide now what I will do for the rest of my life") that keep them „stuck" in career development. In the latter cases, people need assistance in

developing useful convictions for making effective career decisions. In these cases, the work of John Krumboltz provides a useful framework to support practitioners to guide their clients in career development.

Today challenges in building up a career

During the 20th century when employees had permanent jobs, workers could rely on bureaucratic organizations to provide a great story about how it is their life. Today, individuals can no longer plan to work 30 years to develop their career within the boundaries of a job or organization. In contrast, over the lifetime, people can be expected to occupy at least 10 jobs, more appropriately called assignments (Saratoga Institute, 2000). One in four workers in the United States is current employers for the same organization for less than a year (Bureau of Labor Statistics, 2004). New labour market is unsettled

and regards career not as a lifetime commitment to an employer but as a recurring sale of services and skills to a range of employers who require projects to be completed. An examination of contemporary employment practices show that social reorganization of labour produced a new psychological contract between organizations and their members (Rousseau, 1996). Today, workers must be lifelong learners who make a commitment to an organization for a given period of time and prove professional character and emotional labour in achieving rapid adaptation to work environmental changes. The new contract has prompted employability and human resource management to conceptualize careers without borders (Arthur, 1994), customized (Benko and Weisberg, 2007), kaleidoscopic (Sullivan and Mainiero, 2008), and as a portfolio (Handy, 1998).

As suggested by Super (1957), instead of one set

of career stages Hall and Mirvis (1996) depict there are now multiple, shorter learning cycles over the life span. Thus, an individual's career will be characterized by a series of stages of exploration-trial-mastery-exit across functions, organizations, and other work boundaries. (Sullivan, 1999). A new cycle will be driven by constant learning and mastery rather than by chronological age. This approach integrates Super's (1957) developmental career stage model and the career concept of no boundaries (Arthur & Rousseau, 1996; Hall, 1996a).

As Baruch suggests (Baruch; 2006), the main shift in the relationship between employers and employees was manifested in the change of psychological contracts which took place in the last decades of the 20th Century (Conway & Briner, 2005; Rousseau, 1995). A psychological contract is characterized as a set of "individual beliefs, shaped by the organization, regarding

terms of an exchange agreement between individuals and their organizations" (Rousseau, 1995). From the organizational point of view, the new psychological contract mostly meant a move from offering careers characterized by a secure employment for all, to „opportunities for development" only for those needed and fit for their jobs (Herriot & Pemberton, 1995; Rousseau, 1995, 1996). Individuals discovered that they have a variety of career goals, career anchors (Schein, 1985; Baruch, 2004a), and perspectives of what do they mean by career success (Derr, 1986; Gunz & Heslin, 2005).

The psychological employment contract between organizations and employees has also altered. If under the old contract, workers exchanged loyalty for job security, under the new contract, workers exchange performance for continuous learning and marketability (Altman & Post, 1996; Hall & Mirvis, 1996; Rousseau, 1989; Rousseau & Wade-

Benzoni, 1995). This change in the psychological contract has resulted in decreased job security, (Batt, 1996; Beckman, 1996; Scott, O'Shaughnessy, & Cappelli, 1996), decreased employee loyalty (Goffee & Scase, 1992; Murrell, Frieze, & Olson, 1996), and increased worker cynicism (Kanter & Mirvis, 1989).

Frequent job dislocation and destabilization are sending workers into drifting careers as trying to chart the future and form their identities. To enter the world of work today requires more effort, a deeper self-knowledge and a greater confidence than before. Individuals who have to cope with unstable occupations and transitions in place should be mentioned here may require substantially more help from career counsellors.

The two major paradigms for career interventions in the 21st century were vocational guidance and career education. Vocational guidance remains a psychology of fixed characteristics and types that

can be objectified by tests and then matched to occupations that offer stable long tenure. Career education remains a predictable trajectory of development tasks that can be alleviated by teaching individuals mature attitudes and skills that prepare them to unfold careers in different organizations. Matching the vocational guidance and career preparation through education may not adequately address the design life of the individuals' needs in the information society.

As the work shape changes from stable to labour mobility in order to reflect the needs of post-traditional societies, career interventions strategies must change too. Guidance and training paradigms must now be replaced by a new paradigm that addresses the full life design need of workers in companies (Duarte, 2009). Life course individualization (Beck, 2002) requires knowledge of interventions that deal with the construction of self and achieve career. Together

with the change in shifting career responsibilities from institutions to individuals, people need to get a life (Habermas and Bluck, 2000) and to bridge the transitions in life by using what is called biographicity (Alheit, 1995) and work identity (Sveningsson and Alvesson, 2003).

Autobiographical reasoning and reflexive identity work involves training activities, maintaining and revising the narrative identities characterized by distinctiveness, consistency and continuity. These narrative processes produce the identity capital of knowing the story of one's life. Individuals must then invest capital identity and their stories to cope with uncertainty prompted by occupational workplace transitions. As workers move from one task to another, they must leave behind what they did and yet not who they are and this loss could overwhelm them. By keeping the self in the form of life stories that provide consistency and continuity, they are able to pursue their goals and

projects with integrity and vitality.

Career practitioners and researchers are formulating constructs to help customers negotiate life career changes without losing the sense of self and social identity (Guichard, 2005). To assist customers in building / designing their life for the 21st century, many career counsellors are now focused on identity rather than personality, adaptability rather than maturity, intent rather than decide, and stories rather than scores. Psychological constructs like identity, adaptability and intentionality help formulate a new model for understanding the vocational behaviour (Savickas, 2005b). This psychological theory of vocational behaviour comes from an epistemological position called life designing, which focuses on contextual possibilities, dynamic processes, nonlinear progress, multiple perspectives, and personal patterns (Savicksa et al., 2009). In relation to career, this

constructionist perspective emphasizes flexibility, employability, commitment, emotional intelligence, and lifelong learning.

Life Design: A new paradigm for career development

Life design is a new paradigm for career interventions. Kuhn (1996) describes a paradigm as a set of practices that define a scientific discipline at any particular period of time. A paradigm is a conceptual model that is widely accepted in a community of practice and is usually prevailing view of best practice. Career interventions paradigm means general pattern of practice that includes many specific examples. Paradigm for vocational guidance is to (a) improve knowledge about itself, (b) increase occupational information, and (c) to match self with occupation specific substantiations of this conceptual model including person-environment

fit approach advocated by Holland (1997) and Lofquist, and Dawis (1991). Paradigm for career education is to (a) evaluate the status of development, (b) directs the individual to imminent development tasks, and (c) develop attitudes and skills needed to master those tasks. Specific examples of this conceptual model and its emphasis placed on learning can be found in instances known as career development and counselling assessment (Niles, 2001 Super, 1983), integrative life planning (Hansen, 1997), social-cognitive framework for choosing and career counselling (Brown and Lent, 1996) and learning theory of career counselling (Krumboltz, 1996).

Examples that invoke general conceptual model include the style of career assessment and counselling (Savickas, 1989), narrative career counselling (Cochran, 1997), constructivist career counselling (Peavy, 1997), career building by

targeted actions (Young and Valach, 2004), My System of Career Influences (McMahon, Patton and Watson, 2005), My Career Chapter (McIlveen, 2007), Discovery of Occupational Activities and Personal Plans (Guichard, 2008), the realization of metaphors (Amundson, 2010) and chaos theory of career counselling (Pryor and Bright, 2011).

All these specific instances of life design paradigm share the same life purpose: to prompt activities aim to further self-designing, to shape identity, and career building (Savickas, 2010). Each method uses autobiographical stories that lead customers through their ambiguity by creating scenarios linking future initiatives of past achievements. In due course, each client is the author of a biography which may express their personal truths and authorizes an identity that projects the client into the future. Life design paradigm structures life interventions in (a) build a career through short stories, (b) deconstructing

and rebuilding these stories in a narrative identity or a portrait of life, and (c) co-building intentions that lead to the next episode action in the real world.

During building a career through short stories, when individuals are displaced from their current story, they begin processing their biographical narrative (Heinz, 2002). Some individuals seek counselling to assist in this identity designing work. With these clients, life design interventions start by describing the incident so that he dislodged the current episode in their history and their goals for a new scenario that they want to co-build with a counsellor. Clients are asked to narrate short stories that demonstrate how they built self, identity and career. Life design intervention focuses on narrative because stories are building tools to design social identities careers from complex social interactions. Storytelling builds up self and crystallizes what

customers think about themselves. The more stories they tell, the more customers develop their identities and careers. Individuals make up stories to organize events in their lives in a sequence. Each educational and vocational position that was occupied it can be seen as a short story in the novel of their careers. In the theory of career construction sequence positions in the story summary the career goal.

While deconstructing, in some cases, customer stories include dominant expectations or insidious ideas that suppress several alternatives to improve life. Counsellors should always think carefully about how stories can be deconstructed in order to reveal self limiting ideas, confining roles, and cultural barriers. In particular, they should be sensitive to the axioms of meaning and ideological biases on gender, race, and social status. When stories require deconstruction, advisors can discuss with customers who assume,

oversee, omit, forget, or inadequately address a particular story. Deconstructing seeks to undo the uncritical domination over the client's perspective, not to ruin the story. The goal is to access different meanings and new knowledge that open possibilities and restart initiatives. After listening closely the client building up the story, and perhaps some of the ideas and incidents are deconstructed, the counsellor reconstructs the short story into a great story.

While reconstructing, narrative processing of identity construction gathers short tales about major incidents, recurrent episodes, significant figures, defining moments of self and life-changing experiences. When working with short tales, counsellor actively gathers the story threads and weaves them into a tapestry to craft a unified sense of individuality. Integration of the described short stories about themselves into social situations, builds a macro-story, which

represents a narrative identity. Macro-stories reconstruct experiences to make sense and sediment values, attitudes, and habits into a big story on a person's life. The person becomes a character in a world that he/she has built up. The narrative about identity provides a life story of the self as a social being; provides personal and social meaning of a life driven from speaking patterns and progress.

Identity macro-stories explain the client's past, guiding them to the present and future. To do this, the narrative identity emphasizes occupational plot and themes of career short story sequences. Plots sequence structure episodes into a coherent whole, bringing attention to some facts and ignoring others. Emplotting means to place micro-stories about what happened in the context of macro-story on what happened. Emplotting the sequence of episodes into a great story adds explanatory links and causal coherence to

experience that might otherwise seem random. In life design, rebuilding means to configure and integrate the agents, goals, meanings and interactions to form a meaningful narrative identity or a portrait of life. The explicit plot tells about the outer journey and what happened. This inner journey draws an emotional odyssey shaped by a central conflict with its associated needs. Default theme adds meaning and purpose to the plot of macro-story. As individuals incorporates new experience, they use the default themes to digest plot episodes by imposing an understandable pattern on them; when individuals cope with the challenges and disruptions, pattern recurring themes of macro-stories directs, regulate and support their idea.

While co-constructing, once a narrative identity of the client is rebuilt throughout micro-stories, the counsellor presents a draft on clients' portrait of life, including the occupational plot, career issues,

and character. A primary goal in life narrative portrait to clients is to make them believe the macro-stories rebuilt by the advisor. Reflecting on life portrait typically leads to editing the client narrative identity. This revision involves amendments able to correct mistakes, adjustments to come to terms with old conflicts and settle accounts and alternations that enhance self-esteem and encourage a more optimistic outlook on life. However, macro-stories review involves more than giving an accurate voice to customer's life story. Customers must change the portrait to make it liveable and then extend it to the future. This is the reason for them coming to counselling. The process of review and elaboration opens possibilities for rearranging the elements of the story.

Clients and counsellors work together to candidly craft a movement that faces election. Co-constructing life portrait seeks to incorporate the

current dislocation in a way that clarifies priorities, mobilizes central tendencies, and increase the possibility of transformation and development. This happens as the customer accesses different meanings and knowledge that open new possibilities and restart postponed initiatives. With a new language, fresh perspectives and expanded vistas, customers can reorganize their system of meanings and clarify what is at stake in the next episode of their career story. Then customers are prepared to face the challenges and disruptions using plot and themes to provide overarching goals, rules, order, safety and value. With this newfound clarity, customers can imagine the following scene, to form intentions and begin to act.

A good story about themselves encourages customers to make career transitions while holding a self that is more vital and purposeful. A revised narrative identity allows individuals to

cope with the uncertainties of transition. Life design builds us links to the world that is to face promoting intention and action. While scripting the next scene, counsellor brings up clients' experience ahead of themselves; action needed to transform intentions into behaviour is infused with meaning (Malrieu, 2003). Action has inherent sense of the past while projecting the person into the future. Through action, not verbal expression of decidedness, customers involve the world (Krieshok, Black and McKay, 2009).

Going deeper into the world answers questions brought into counselling. Action prompts on the composition of the self, identity formation, and career building. To conclude consultation, counsellors ask clients if they have served their purpose brought to counselling. Counsellors usually end the session with a few sentences to summarize what happened by strengthening co-constructed story and explaining how it relates to

the client. Counsellors can use the terms of tension, attention, intention and extension to explain the results - counselling outcome. Together the client and counsellor have given attention to that stress in the form of career stories. Then they rebuilt tension into intention. After counselling, the client seeks an extension of self in purposeful actions that resolve the tension.

The Chaos Theory of Careers – CTC

Chaos theory is a mathematical theory (Lorentz) that has been applied successfully in many of the natural sciences. In career counselling, this theory is relevant as a basis for practice when helping clients deal with complexity, chance and change. The complexity of influences on career development challenge accurate predictability. CTC core concepts regard:

- **COMPLEXITY-** Processes and influences

shape each person's life. Chaos theory emphasizes encouraging understanding these processes and patterns instead of "defining or predicting stable variables as outcomes" (Bright & Pryor, 2005, p. 296).

- **EMERGENCE -** Chaos theory focuses on the complexity of human experience, in complexity patterns begin to emerge. Emergence works to make sense out of past experiences.
- **NONLINEARITY -** Small changes or influences can make a dramatic, if not disproportionate impact. When reviewing past career experiences, it is important to look at everything, even what seems to be trivial, to help shed light on the result.
- **UNPREDICTABILITY** - Chance events will influence a client's career. Encouraging exploration of these events will help clients understand the uncertain nature of careers. Counsellors can help clients recognize and take

advantage of future chance events.

- **PHASE SHIFTS -** Clients "can undergo radical changes in career direction" (Bright & Pryor, 2005, p. 296). These changes can be due to external factors or internal factors.
- **ATTRACTORS -** Attractors influence behaviour as a pull or as a constraint. Within chaos theory, the notion of 'attractors' is used to describe the way in which complex dynamical systems behave. According to Bright & Pryor (2005) there are 4 types:

– Point: "behaviour when the object is attracted to one specific thing" (p. 300); This describes a system that moves toward a fixed or defined point or outcome. In many respects, the career notions of being on the right track or finding a good fit through matching are consistent with this view of movement in a singular direction toward a clearly identifiable goal. There is no room here for deviation from a

well-constructed life or career plan.

– Pendulum: "constrains behaviour to a regular, predictable pattern" (p. 300); With this type of movement the system begins to incorporate shifts between two points or outcomes, like the swinging of a pendulum. There are competing sources of attraction and people are faced with choosing between two very different options.

– Torus: "more complex but is ultimately constrained and repeating" (p. 301); With this form of attraction there is an increase in complexity, but at the same time also a high level of predictability. Complex patterns are repeated over a period of time. While there is some challenge in learning the nature of the pattern, there is also a certain constancy that one can depend upon. As long as one follows the prescribed pattern there is certainty about the outcome.

– Strange: "never repeating but self-similar" (p. 301); This final pattern is complex in a similar manner to the torus attractor but there is one fundamental difference, the outcome is not predictable.

The Chaos Theory of Careers (Pryor and Bright; 2011) provides an overview of the common models in career choice and guidance and presents the limitations of these theories in today's complex, ever changing and unpredictable world.

At the core of CTC we will find complexity, which allows many different perspectives to be embraced, even those that contradict and oppose one another. The other main concepts are self-organization, which causes systems to seek out and form patterns; and change, viewed in terms of adaptation and resilience.

As authors describe, chaos theory is related to goal setting, strategic planning, career paths,

creativity and leadership, presenting the broad value that the theory can bring to organizations. Chaos theory introduces new themes into careers work as it did in the scientific world, namely embracing uncertainty, the importance of chance and recognition that the order we try to impose on nature is often too simplistic.

Understanding „attractors" is necessary when understanding clients who fail to engage with their career development or are limited in their thinking. As the well-known butterfly effect suggests, small changes can lead to very diverse outcomes.

External factors generally can influence the overall functioning of the system. Thus, unpredictability becomes part of the process and as a result people are expected to shift from closed to boundaryless system thinking.

The need to prepare for strange attractors is a key element within chaos theory and is developed

further through the concept of fractal patterns. The concept of patterns within human functioning is a core aspect of career development theory and practice. Patterns that are similar across scale are described using the term „fractal" (Mandelbrot, 1982). There is the recognition in chaos theory that both regularity and randomness need to be included to understand the true nature of patterns in the real world, as contrasted with mathematical models. Pryor and Bright (2011, p. 64) indicate that „fractals are the records of the stability and change exhibited by the functioning of strange attractors". Career development is focused on the identification of competency models, personality style, values and interests. From the perspective of chaos theory, although there is some consistency in this process, there is also a great deal of unexpected influences. Understanding the fractal nature of patterns allows us to look for some elements of constancy while at the same

time being open to the limits of predictability. In navigating personal fractals, it is often useful to approach situations from a variety of perspectives. Each perspective offers some understanding but also has some limits. By using multiple perspectives it is possible to obtain greater understanding, and creativity is also enhanced (Combs & Freedman, 1990).

Utilizing chaos theory in career counselling does not require having a completely new toolbox. Many of the classic techniques can be utilized successfully, including those standards used in trait factor approach. The aim of using any of the techniques is to help clients in better understanding their convergent and emergent qualities. Convergent qualities are inherent in each person and include skills, values, IQ, and knowledge, basically the things that can be assessed. Emergent qualities come from "the complex interaction of the many and varied

factors that influence career behaviour" (Pryor & Bright, 2006, p. 4). These qualities can be challenging because they cannot be predicted, they are unique and sometimes determine a person's career path.

Often standardized assessment measures are used as tools to determine the best possible options. With an emergent view the focus is on expansion and the exploration of possibilities. To achieve this end there is a need for creativity, intuition, and openness and a willingness to consider and craft new options (Amundson, 2009). This more expansive perspective involves risk taking, acceptance of uncertainty, working with incomplete knowledge, focusing on one's passions, following one's curiosity, being in touch with intuition and learning from mistakes (Pryor, Amundson, & Bright, 2008). A wide variety of qualitative exploration activities (card sorts, mind mapping, creative questioning, storytelling,

collage, drawings and so forth) are often used as tools for exploration. Pryor and Bright (2011, p. 142) suggest that „convergent knowledge tends to be represented by simple metrics, whereas emergent qualities are best captured with more complex structures such as patterns and narratives".

One goal of CTC counselling is to "push the boundaries of clients" limitations to explore how rigid or flexible they might be, i.e. to develop capacities for change' (Pryor & Bright, 2011, p. 90). Chaos career theorists acknowledge that it is highly adaptive to focus on stability and control over one's career, however, becoming too set in one's ways and ignoring the possibilities of unforeseen changes can leave individuals unprepared to face unexpected events. It is the combination of careful planning and being open to potential changes that ultimately leads to a viable career development (McKay et al., 2005).

Researchers in chaos career theory have described several methods to help clients accept life's uncertainties when developing their careers. In order to open clients' perspective to possibilities outside of the probable and predictable outcomes, chaos career theorists suggested „contingency planning", whereby clients are encouraged to consider the possibility, probability and plans for various career situations (Pryor & Bright, 2012). Authors suggest reviewing a client's life narrative and uncovering themes in order to help clients make sense of the twists and turns that had happened in their lives (Pryor & Bright, 2008).

An approach to increasing clients' coping with uncertainty is to help them discover core values, which can guide them into making value-driven decisions amid the chaotic sea of possibilities. McKay (2005) has documented the use of card-sorting tasks, questionnaires and interviews in

uncovering clients' values.

Additional exercises have been detailed by Pryor & Bright (2006) for to use in either individual or group sessions. These exercises help counsellors to understand and utilize the theory relative to the client.

THE SIGNATURE EXERCISE - In summary, the client(s) writes his/ her name multiple times within a given time period. The goals of the exercise are to (a) show that reality is based on self-organization and chance, (b) life includes order and randomness, (c) patterns and variations can appear at the same time (d) demonstrate the limits of control even over common tasks, (e) show differences between emergent and convergent thinking patters.

THE SOMETIMES MAGIC EXERCISE - In summary, *Sometimes Magic* cards are handed to client(s) and the client(s) is instructed to think of examples of circumstances where they may have had

special experiences. Counsellors follow up with questions about the experiences to achieve the following goals: (a) recognition of the unexpected in the experiences; (b) help explore the newly discovered understanding of the client(s) history (c) help clients discover ways to be more creative. *THE PARABLE OF THE PING-PONG BALL* - In summary, the parable is an everyday example that either given to the client(s) to read, is read out loud, or is drawn by the counsellor. The goals of the parable are: (a) increased complexity leads to decreased ability to predict outcomes; (b) even when accurate prediction is limited, it doesn't mean that the experience can't be explained or understood; (c) demonstrate that change is nonlinear; (d) to introduce the concept of phase shift; (e) show limitations of knowledge and control and the need to make decisions with limited knowledge of influences and outcomes; (f) recognize that one will al-ways have to make

decisions and face challenges.

The above exercises can be found, in detail, in the 2006 Pryor & Bright article in the Journal of Employment Counselling.

Narrative identity and Storytelling in career counselling

Choosing a career and pursuing it does not represent an irreversible process that cannot be changed, but the correct choice of a career path and the existence of mechanisms that favour the development of all skills needed for the transition to the labour market, guaranteeing a good investment of time and other resources in the education of a person. In this respect, the existence of counselling and career guidance centres seems more than necessary for both individual benefits offered to people who use such services and societal benefits. It is recognized

that counselling and career guidance can contribute to the maximum development of the professional potential of people in accordance with their aspirations and abilities, reducing academic dropout, an optimal transition of young people between different educational levels, increasing participation in education, developing social inclusion and equity in education or increasing employability by facilitating direct access.

Career counselling is a delimited process throughout a specialist provides support to another person (client) to overcome a number of obstacles related to the field of career, employment (unemployment, need to take an important decision, lack of job satisfaction, etc.) or related to personal life and affecting professional life (lack of organization, communication difficulties, inadequate time management skills etc).

The counselling consists of a series of face to face

meetings during which discussions take place between client and counsellor (interviews, filling out evaluation tests of interests, personality traits, attitudes, discussing results and simulating real situations etc.) in order to clarify the problematic situations that the client faces, and to identify possible solutions and support in adopting the most appropriate decision.

Career counselling most commonly addresses:

- better knowledge of own personal skills, abilities or knowledge;
- finding the optimal education and training path in line with real life contexts of personal projects and resources;
- identifying complementary alternatives to occupational structure of their interests, skills and dominant personality traits;
- shaping positive and realistic self image;
- identifying the causes, nature and extent of decisional barriers regarding occupations;

- maturing decisional autonomy of career development planning;
- compensating for lack of information, incomplete or misleading information and stereotypes about alleviating world of work;
- identifying sources of professional dissatisfaction, incompatibility or difficulty of social networking and assuming different roles.

As from the client's point of view, most individuals try to best cope when navigating their career development in a complex world of work context. Individuals access career guidance services as they seek answers to questions regarding past, present and future self identity. Clients are uncertain of all these identity tenses, and are situated in a constant search for a better understanding, controlling and predicting own identity.

The *main challenge* facing career counsellors in the process of seeking new ways of responding to

the complex needs of diverse clients is considered in this article. Narrative career counselling has been widely viewed as the best approach to address this challenge as it offers the possibility of a new identity for the field and a sustainable and achievable future story (Savickas et al., 2009). The narrative career counselling paradigm has evolved into several approaches, including the story telling approach (McMahon, 2006; McMahon & Watson, 2010, 2012). In order to depict the potential of narrative career counselling, the storytelling approach is provided as a powerful technique for crafting client's self identities in contextually anchored ways.

Fundamental to narrative approaches is storytelling, which Cochran (2007) describes as a „human universal". In narrative approaches to career counselling, stories are elicited in different ways including the use of qualitative career assessment instruments. Amundson (2003)

describes the narrative career counselling process „active engagement". Amundson (2003) describes strategies such as the Pattern Identification Exercise to elicit themes common to the stories. The life design approach utilises a career style interview (Savickas, 2005) that comprises five questions to elicit stories from clients and subsequently their themes. In the story telling approach, the My System of Career Influences qualitative career assessment instrument may be used to elicit stories (McMahon, Watson, Chetty, & Hoelson, 2012a, 2012b).

Telling stories is one of the most natural human activities. Consciously or not, we build, listen and narrate stories every day. Naturally, storytelling has become one of the favourite ways of communication, simply because it is effective.

People no longer seek simply sending a message, but engaging the public (audience) in a long-term relationship with the brand, no matter what that

brand is (a product, a service, own self). But the consumer is bombarded with promotions and involvement attempts in all sorts of actions; it becomes less responsive to promotional material, developing a sort of immunity to the standard structure of advertising discourse and becoming more reluctant to credibility and usefulness of information coming from brands.

But the stories do not respect this structure, which revolves around brands and they are trying to persuade the audience to buy, test, click, like, share or hire. Stories leave the realm of demagoguery and hypocrisy, inviting the audience on a journey that will be at least as interesting, exciting, strange or funny, as they wish to be, thus satisfying a certain need.

If well written stories add an emotional dimension to communication, they generate sympathy and help "readers" much easier to retain information. Furthermore, the information submitted by stories

becomes much easier to share with other people. To translate the values and mission of a brand into a story seems a simple thing to do, but not every story is captivating; to create a story that is enjoyable and memorable it takes hard work and talent.

Whatever form it will take, whether it is a video, a text or an oral communication, there are some rules and principles universally valid. One of them, learned from early school, clearly defining moments is subject. In 1863, Gustav Freytag, developed a model based upon Aristotle's theory of tragedy. This is now called “Freytag's pyramid” which divides a drama into five parts, and provides function to each part. These essential components of any message that will take the form of stories are: exposition, rising action, climax, falling action, and denouement. The inciting incident represents the event or decision that triggers a story’s problem/dilemma. Before

this moment there is equilibrium, a relative peace that the characters in a story have grown accustomed to. This incisive moment, or plot point occurs and upsets the balance of things. Suddenly there is a problem to be solved.

As stories are about problem solving, sometimes they are solved, other times, they aren't. Regardless of outcome, this inciting incident starts the action by introducing an inequity into the lives of the characters that inhabit the story.

These plot points naturally split a story into four parts mainly because for every problem there are four basic contexts from which one can design the way to solve a problem. Once explored all four contexts, the story is over, any continuation would simply be a rehash of something that has already been happened.

Paradoxically, stories about brands must not have as main character the brand itself. The reason why stories are so popular is that no matter the

subject, the reader makes the story about itself, identifying with the character, or with a more abstract entity such as a value, a belief or attitude. A well-written story, which has in the foreground an unwise chosen character, will undoubtedly be an ineffective story. From the perspective of promotional messages, a bad character means a character that falls into the category of those with whom the audience does not identifies with, or represents some ideals not to follow.

Once understood what problems the audience faces, what expectations and attitudes towards certain social phenomena, one can effectively build on these pillars a story, so it will be very easy for audience to identify with.

Every story has a moral, a parable or a final perspective that needs to be transmitted. A story that does not generate a change in attitude, perception or behaviour is one that has not

reached its goal. Moreover, when it comes to promotional messages, the story is only the means by which information is conveyed. Analogies and comparisons are used especially when the information that wants to be promoted is new and foreign to audience or difficult to accept. Making the analogy between this information and another, to which the receptors already have a firm or a positive attitude, it creates a perception and meaning transfer between the two.

Probably the most common rhetorical trick in promotion messages, is typically used when the audience is cautious, rigid or when the message regards a social nature cause. The appeal to emotions and empathy harnesses the power of social pressure put on the audience in order to accept the message. Using humour attracts the goodwill of audience towards the message, and has the power to create exclusive groups, which

include only those people who appreciate a certain kind of humour.

There is also a risk that the method of "packing" messages in stories is not efficient, because of how it is implemented or the context in which it is used. Stories are not suitable for any promotional objectives, for instance, sales objectives aim at promoting a more direct approach. Storytelling is effective for brand targets, to attract attention, awareness, and public goodwill. A story full of clichés will normally be seen as false, and the receiver will feel like being cheated or even worse, that the message sender is underestimating their critical sense and the ability to discern.

Therefore, any kind of promotional messages in the form of stories represents a good way to attract public attention and cause them to react in a certain way. But to achieve these results, the story must be authentic, inspired by the

audiences' life or current concerns and have built a good message, such as when reading, seeing or listening to the end, the connection between the brand and the content of the story must be clear.

A key concept in nowadays personality psychology is narrative identity, referring to an individual internalized, evolving and integrative story of the self. The stories individuals develop to make meaning out of their existence serve to situate them within the social and modern adulthood (McAdams, 2008). It is within the realm of narrative identity, therefore, that personality shows it's most important and intricate relations to culture and society (McAdams, 2006).

Career interventions paradigm means general pattern of practice that includes many specific examples. Paradigm for vocational guidance is to (a) improve knowledge about itself, (b) increase occupational information, and (c) to match self

with occupation specific substantiations of this conceptual model including person-environment fit approach advocated by Holland (1997) and Lofquist and Dawis (1991). Paradigm for career education is to (a) evaluate the status of development, (b) directs the individual to imminent development tasks, and (c) develop attitudes and skills needed to master those tasks. Specific examples of this conceptual model and its emphasis placed on learning can be found in instances known as career development and counselling assessment (Niles, 2001 Super, 1983), integrative life planning (Hansen, 1997), social-cognitive framework for choosing and career counselling (Brown & Lent, 1996) and learning theory of career counselling (Krumboltz, 1996).

Examples that invoke general conceptual model include the style of career assessment and counselling (Savickas, 1993), narrative career

counselling (Cochran, 1997), constructivist career counselling (Peavy, 1998), career building by targeted actions (Young and Valach, 2004), My System of Career Influences (McMahon, Patton & Watson, 2005), My Career Chapter (McIlveen, 2007), Discovery of Occupational Activities and Personal Plans (Guichard, et. al. 2012), the realization of metaphors (Amundson, 2010) and chaos theory of career counselling (Pryor & Bright, 2011).

All these specific instances of life design paradigm share the same life purpose: to prompt activities aim to further self-designing, to shape identity, and career building (Savickas, 2011). Each method uses autobiographical stories that lead clients through their ambiguity by creating scenarios linking future initiatives of past achievements. Each client is the author of a biography which may express their personal truths and authorizes an identity that projects the

client into the future.

Thus, the stories clients build up to make sense of their lives are fundamentally about their struggle to reconcile who they imagine they are, with who they are and they might be in the complex social contexts; the self comes to terms with society through narrative identity (McAdams, 2008). Through the telling of stories, underlying themes emerge that permeate past and present stories and provide a scaffold for a future story (McMahon & Watson, 2013).

In career guidance, crafting a future story and a future identity must take account of the stories clients have told, thus the future story will be grounded in the stories of past and present experiences (Gergen & Gergen, 2006; Oyserman & James, 2011, 2012; White, 2007), experiences which are culturally constructed (Cohen, 2006).

When telling their stories and the crafting of future stories individuals engage in a reflective

learning process (Meijers & Lengelle, 2012). Krumboltz (1996) claimed that the mail role of career counsellors is „to generate learning experiences for their clients", suggesting career counsellors to be less concerned about whether their clients were making decisions and more focused on whether their clients were learning, emphasising the process rather than the outcome of career counselling.

The story telling approach to narrative career counselling (McMahon, 2006; McMahon & Watson, 2010, 2012) is grounded in the Systems Theory Framework (STF; McMahon & Patton, 1995; Patton & McMahon, 1999, 2006) of career development. STF describes the complexity of individuals' lives through dynamic, recursively connected individual, social and environmental-societal systems of influence. The basic assumption is that these systems of influences are located within the context of time, past

experiences influencing the present lives of individuals and, together, past and present experiences influence the future of the individual. The systems of the STF represent the content of stories and also the sites within which stories have been constructed by individuals over time, being dynamic in nature. These dynamics reflected in its process constructs of recursiveness, change over time and chance, all of which account for changes and interaction within and between the systems of influence over time (McAdams, 2008).

The core aspect of these systems is represented by the interdependence of their parts, relationship between the whole, its parts, and its environment; interaction rather than linear causes-and-effects (Collin, 2006). Thus, STF provides a map for the career counsellors (McMahon & Patton, 2006) that facilitates exploration of the "complex web of relationships

… the complex interactions that take place, and so highlighting crucial influences and tensions" (Collin, 2006) in clients' stories.

The constructs of process, learning and reflection are central to the STF and also to the story telling approach. Theoretical concepts like connectedness, meaning making and agency are fundamental to the story telling approach. Connectedness reflects the dynamic systemic underpinning of the story telling approach and the recursive interaction that occurs within and between individuals' systems of influence. Meaning making occurs as individuals recount their stories in order to make sense of their experiences, as in the case of career counselling. Agency reflects a belief that individuals have taken an active role in the construction of their stories, their ability to tell stories and also to enact future stories (McAdams, 2008).

As for learning and reflection (McMahon et al.,

2012a), the STF conceptualises career counselling as a learning system in which counselling is regarded as a learning process, career counsellors as learning facilitators and individuals as lifelong learners striving to make sense of their life experiences. Thus learning becomes a dialogical and cognitive process (Meijers & Lengelle, 2012) as well as a transformative process (McMahon et al., 2012a) that is brought about through reflection. For instance, the recursive processes of connectedness, meaning making, reflection, learning and agency result in transformation as individuals arrive at a different end point or a new understanding of the same end point (McMahon et al., 2012a). During the dialogical process in the story telling approach, individuals tell stories of their experiences and, by reflecting on those experiences at both objective and subjective levels, transformation occurs, informing the construction of their future stories (McAdams,

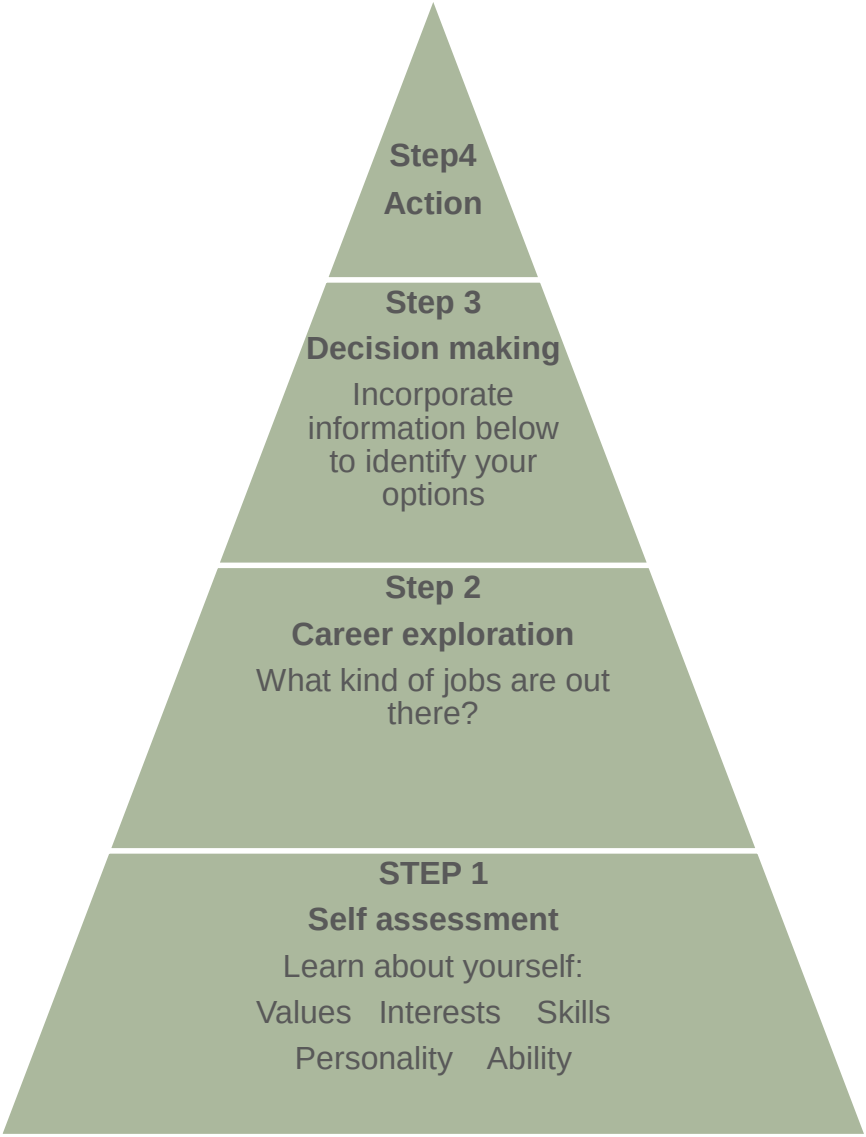
2008).

Nevertheless, stories told by individuals are not created in a social vacuum (Law, Meijers, & Wijers, 2002). Similarly, the emergence of narrative approaches such as story telling has not been created in a vacuum. McAdams (2008) clearly stated that part of the challenge for career counselling field has been the need to reconsider career guidance theory and practice that is more sensitive to the needs of non-dominant groups and that takes into account the broader socio-political location of individuals' stories (Stead & Watson, 2006; Watson, 2009), stories being embedded in the narrative discourse of families, communities and societies (Combs & Freedman, 1994). Thus, career stories reflect the cultures in which they are constructed and told (McAdams, 2006).

1. SELF ASSESSMENT

WHAT IS SELF – ASSESSMENT?

Self-assessment is simply a matter of having students identify strengths and weaknesses in their own work and revise accordingly. Effective self-assessment involves students comparing their work to clear standards and generating feedback for themselves about where they need to make improvements. It is a tool that can promote learning if it is used while the learning is taking place. In order for self-assessment to be effective, students must be able to use their self-generated feedback to revise and improve their work before it is due for grading. Self assessment is the first step of the career planning process.


Step4
Action
Step 3
Decision making
Incorporate information below to identify your options
Step 2
Career exploration
What kind of jobs are out there?
STEP 1
Self assessment
Learn about yourself:
Values Interests Skills
Personality Ability

During a self assessment they gather information about themself in order to make an informed career decision.

A self assessment should include a look at the following: values, interests, personality, and skills. Values are the things that are important to you, like achievement, status, and autonomy. Interests are what you enjoy doing, i.e. playing golf, taking long walks, hanging out with friends. Personality is a person's individual traits, motivational drives, needs, and attitudes. Skills are the activities you are good at, such as writing, computer programming, and teaching.

1. WORK VALUES

The following list describes a wide range of satisfaction that people gain from their jobs.Rate the degree of importance of the following words, using the scale below:

1. Not important at all

2. Not very important

3. Reasonably important

4. Very important in my choice of career

_____ Help Society: Do something which contributes to improving the world we live in. _____ Help Others: Be directly included in helping other people, either individually or in small groups.

_____ Public Contact: Have a lot of day-to-day contact with the public.

_____ Work with Others: Work as a team member toward common goals.

_____ Work Alone: Do projects by myself, with limited contact with others.

_____ Competition: Engage in activities which pit my abilities against others.

_____ Make Decisions: Have the power to decide courses of action and policies.

_____ Work Under Pressure: Work in situations where time pressure is prevalent.

_____ Influence People: Be in a position to influence the attitudes or opinions of other people.

_____ Knowledge: Engage in the pursuit of

knowledge and understanding.

_____ Work Mastery: Become an expert in whatever work I do.

_____ Artistic Creativity: Engage in creative artistic expression.

_____ General Creativity: Have the opportunity to create new programs, materials, or organizational structures.

_____ Aesthetics: Participate in studying or appreciating the beauty of things, ideas, etc.

_____ Supervision: Have a job in which I am directly responsible for the work of others.

_____ Change and Variety: Have work activities which frequently change.

_____ Precision Work: Work in situations where attention to detail and accuracy are very important.

_____ Stability: Have a work routine and job duties that are largely predictable.

_____ Security: Be assured of keeping my job and

receiving satisfactory compensation.

_____ Recognition: Be publicly recognized for the high quality of my work.

_____ Fast Pace: Work in circumstances where work must be done rapidly.

_____ Excitement: Experience a high degree of (or frequent) excitement in the course of my work.

_____ Adventure: Have work duties which require frequent risk-taking.

_____ Financial Gain: Have a high likelihood of achieving very great monetary rewards for my work.

_____ Physical Challenge: Do activities that use my physical capabilities.

_____ Independence: Be able to determine the nature of my work without significant direction from others.

_____ Moral Fulfillment: Feel that my work contributes to a set of moral standards which I feel are very important.

_____ Community: Live where I can participate in

community affairs.

_____ Time Freedom: Be able to work according to my own schedule.

Add others which are important to you:

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

My 5 essential values are:

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

2. INTERESTS

The following exercise will help you organize an inventory of your interests and then relates them to general occupational fields. Answer the

following questions with a Yes or No depending on how strongly you feel about each item

Please add up your scores in each interest category along the questions. Use the following: Yes!= 4; yes = 3; no = 1; No! = 0.

Important: There is no right answer and the point of this test is not to score the highest score, it will only categorise your interest in order to asses them.

Mechanical Interests

Mechanical Interests	Yes!	yes	no	No!
Do you like to work with your hands?				
Do you like to repair things?				
Do you like to work with tools?				
Do you like to operate machinery?				
Do you like physical work?				
Do you like to work outdoors?				
Totals	Yes!	yes	no	No!
Total Mechanical interests				

Theory Interests

Theory Interests	Yes!	yes	no	No!
Do you like to solve problems?				
Do you like ambiguous challenges?				
Do you like to read and study?				
Do you like math or science?				
Do you like to investigate physical things?				
Do you like to investigate physical things?				
Do you like to think through problems more than work them out?				
Totals	Yes!	yes	no	No!
Total Theory interests				

Artistic Interests

Artistic Interests	Yes!	yes	no	No!
Do you like to express yourself?				

Do you like freedom from structure?				
Do you like unconventional solutions?				
Do you like aesthetic statements?				
Do you like to work alone?				
Do you like creative situations?				
Totals	Yes!	yes	no	No!
Total Artistic Interests				

Social Interests

Social Interests	Yes!	yes	no	No!
Do you like to care for others?				
Do you like to work with people?				
Do you like to be part of a group?				
Do you like to help others?				
Do you like to train others?				
Do you like to supervise people?				
Totals	Yes!	yes	no	No!
Total Social Interests				

Business Interests

Business Interests	Yes!	yes	no	No!
Do you like to persuade others?				
Do you like to be the leader?				
Do you like to speak to groups?				
Do you like to make things happen?				
Do you like to manage projects?				
Do you like to sell things?				
Totals	Yes!	yes	no	No!
Total Business Interests				

Organizational Interests

Organizational Interests	Yes!	yes	no	No!
Do you like to be orderly?				
Do you like well-defined tasks?				
Do you like office procedures?				
Do you like stable situations?				

Do you like a chain of command?				
Do you like to know what is next?				
Totals	Yes!	yes	no	No!
Total Business Interests				

Please report all scores below:

Mechanical interests _____

Theory interests _____

Artistic interests _____

Business interests _____

Organizational interests _____

3. CAREER FIELDS

The following occupations show how your interests compare to people with similar interests who are employed in various fields.

Circle job titles that you find most appealing (2 in each group) and calculate the scores at the end.

They will help you categorize your work interests.

Group 1	**Group 2**
Bus driver A	Firefighter A
Art teacher B	Architect B
College professor C	Physical therapist C
Court reporter D	Pharmacy technician D
Cosmetologist E	Child care assistant E
Florist F	Food service manager F

Group 3	**Group 4**
Carpenter A	Plumber A
Musician B	Chef B
Computer programmer C	Nurse C
Revenue Canada agent D	Dietician D
Special education E	Recreation Leader E
Buyer F	Caterer F

Group 5	**Group 6**
Electrician A	Painter A
Advertising artist B	Author/ writer B
Chemist C	Chiropractor C
Bank teller D	Bookkeeper D
Athletic trainer E	Guidance counsellor E
Barber F	Car/ Gift shop manager F

Group 7	Group 8
Police officer A	Tool/Die Maker A
Copy Writer B	Flight attendant B
Dental Hygienist C	Medical technician C
Secretary D	Food service Manager D
Operating room tech E	Social worker E
Elected public official F	Hotel manager F

Group 9	Group 10
Sheet metal worker A	Truck driver A
Librarian B	Photographer B
Surveyor C	Systems analyst C
Accountant D	Waiter/ress D
Occupational therapist E	YMCA Director E
Insurance agent F	Real estate agent F

Majority of As: Mechanical interests

Majority of Bs: Artistic interests

Majority of Cs: Theory interests

Majority of Ds: Organization interests

Majority of Es: Social interests

Majority of Fs: Business interests

OCCUPATIONAL DAYDREAMS

Below, list the occupations you have considered when thinking about your future. List the careers you have daydreamed about, as well as those you have discussed with others. Try to recount a history of your tentative choices and daydreams. Put your most recent thoughts about job choice on line 1 and work backwards.

Occupations

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

Now that you have identified several career interests, assess your situation and ask yourself some difficult questions. Take each job you have identified and answer the following questions for

each option.

Occupation 1:

What are the qualifications required to obtain such a job?

_____

_____

_____

Which ones do I already have?

_____

_____

Which ones don't I have?

_____

_____

Am I willing or able to invest my time and money to acquire these missing skills?

Yes □ No □

If yes, make a step by step action plan towards the goals. If no, move on to the next job on your list. Do this for all your careers listed and your

goals should begin to look clear.

5. **SKILLS**

According to a 2015 survey conducted by the National Association of Colleges and Employers (NACE), the top qualities/skills employers seek in hires are:

1. Ability to work in a team structure
2. Ability to make decisions and solve problems
3. Ability to verbally communicate with persons inside and outside the organization
4. Ability to plan, organize, and prioritize work
5. Ability to obtain and process information
6. Ability to analyze quantitative data
7. Technical knowledge related to job
8. Proficiency with computer software programs
9. Ability to create and/or edit written reports
10. Ability to sell or influence others

Throughout the course of your life, you have gained competencies in many areas. In which of the following do you excel? This list will help you to realize your strong points that you can apply to career decision-making as well as to transitioning to different fields. Check off the skills that you have demonstrated inside and outside of the study or working field. Then, go back and circle

those skills you most enjoy using and cross off those that you do not enjoy using.

Communication Skills

☐ Present information to large and small groups
☐ Handle complaints in person/over the phone
☐ Sell ideas, products, or services
☐ Listen carefully and attentively
☐ Develop rapport easily with diverse individuals and groups of people
☐ Read or speak another language
☐ Edit and proofread written material
☐ Write clearly and concisely

Counseling, Serving, and Interpersonal Relations Skills

☐ Counsel, advise, consult, guide others
☐Demonstrate empathy, sensitivity, and patience
☐ Help people make their own decisions
☐ Help others improve health and welfare
☐ Listen empathically and with objectivity
☐ Create positive, hospitable environment
☐ Encourage, empower, advocate for people

Creative and Innovative Skills

☐ Visualize concepts and results
☐ Brainstorm and make use of group synergy
☐ Design materials, products, or services

☐ Express ideas through an form
☐ Use computer software for artistic creations
☐ Write poetry, fiction, plays

Financial Skills

☐ Develop/stay within a budget
☐ Eye for profit
☐ Recognize money making opportunities
☐ Manage money/make money grow
☐ Set financial priorities
☐ Develop cost cutting solutions
☐ Negotiate financial deals
☐ Understand economic principles

Leadership, Management, and Administrative Skills

☐ Envision the future and lead change
☐ Establish policy and/or procedures
☐ Set goals and determine courses of action
☐ Create innovative solutions to complex problems
☐ Develop and facilitate work teams
☐ Provide training for development of staff
☐ Demonstrative flexibility during crisis
☐ Evaluate performance
☐ Streamline processes

Mechanical and Technical Skills

☐ Invent
☐ Assemble/build/install
☐ Perform precision work

☐ Operate hand/power tools
☐ Troubleshoot/diagnose problems
☐ Drafting/mechanical drawing
☐ Understand manuals/diagrams
☐ Learn new technology easily
☐ Program/Code

Numerical Skills
☐ Solid ability with basic arithmetic
☐ Multiply numbers in your head
☐ Figure out percentages
☐ Recognize patterns and relationships in numbers
☐ Gain valuable information from graphs, tables, and charts
☐ Quickly spot numerical errors
☐ Make decisions based on numerical data
☐ Make rough calculations/estimates in your head
☐ Analyze statistical data

Planning and Organizing Skills
☐ Identify and organize tasks or information
☐ Coordinate and organize people, activities, processes, systems, and programs
☐ Develop a plan and set objectives
☐ Set up and keep time schedules
☐ Anticipate problems and respond with solutions
☐ Plan and manage events

Problem-Solving Skills

☐ Anticipate/solve problems
☐ Bring order in a chaotic situation
☐ Determine root causes
☐ Select most effective solution
☐ Improvise under stress
☐ Help a group identify solutions
☐ Handle difficult people
☐ Stay calm in emergencies

Research and Analytical Skills

☐ Identify appropriate information sources
☐ Hypothesize and test for results
☐ Compile numerical and statistical data
☐ Classify and sort information into categories
☐ Write analysis of study and research
☐ Compare and evaluate information
☐ Formulate insightful and relevant questions
☐ Use technology for statistical analysis
☐ Keep accurate and complete records

Training and Teaching Skills

☐ Use a variety of media for presentations
☐ Develop educational curriculum and materials
☐ Create and administer evaluation plans
☐ Facilitate a group
☐ Explain difficult ideas, complex topics
☐ Assess learning styles and respond accordingly
☐ Consult and recommend solutions

6. Know your Personality Type with the Holland Code

One way of exploring careers is by looking at occupations according to occupational interest. John Holland conducted research that divided job seekers into six broad personality type categories:

- REALISTIC
- ARTISTIC
- ENTERPRISING
- INVESTIGATIVE
- SOCIAL
- CONVENTIONAL

All types have both positive and negative qualities and none are better than the others. The Holland Code is a generalization, and not likely to be an exact fit. This condensed survey is not intended to be as accurate or comprehensive as a full instrument. Completing this survey might help you identify the cluster(s) of occupations in which you would have the most interest and get the most satisfaction, and it will give you a place to start your career exploration.

Step One:

Circle the number of all items below that are appealing to you - leave the rest blank.

1. Planting and growing crops
2. Solving math problems
3. Being in a play
4. Studying other cultures
5. Talking to people at a party
6. Working with computers
7. Working on cars or lawnmowers
8. Astronomy
9. Drawing or painting
10. Going to church
11. Working on a sales campaign
12. Using a cash register
13. Carpentry
14. Physics
15. Foreign language
16. Working with youth
17. Buying clothes for a store
18. Working from nine to five
19. Setting type for a printing job
20. Using a chemistry set
21. Reading fiction or plays
22. Helping people with problems
23. Selling life insurance
24. Typing reports
25. Driving a truck 26. Working in a lab
27. Playing a musical instrument
28. Making new friends
29. Leading a group

30. Following a budget
31. Fixing electrical appliances
32. Building rocket models
33. Writing stories or poetry
34. Attending sports events
35. Making your opinions heard
36. Using business machines
37. Building things
38. Doing puzzles
39. Fashion design
40. Belonging to a club
41. Giving talks or speeches
42. Keeping detailed records
43. Wildlife biology
44. Using science to get answers
45. Going to concerts or the theater
46. Working with the elderly
47. Sales people
48. Filing letters and reports

Step Two: On the chart below, again circle the numbers of the items which appealed to you. Then count the number for each row and write the number in the box to the left. The two highest categories are the clusters in which you have the most interest, and their corresponding labels are your Holland Code. (For example, if you scored highest in Social, and second highest in Artistic, your Holland Code would be "SA". This is where you will concentrate your career exploration

efforts.)

	R = REALISTIC	1	7	13	19	25	31	37	43
	I = INVESTIGATIVE	2	8	14	20	26	32	38	44
	A = ARTISTIC	3	9	15	21	27	33	39	45
	S = SOCIAL	4	10	16	22	28	34	40	46
	E = ENTERPRISING	5	11	17	23	29	35	41	47
	C = CONVENTIONAL	6	12	18	24	30	36	42	48

In the lists below, you can identify your type, and then focus on your job search

REALISTIC - Robust, rugged, practical, physically strong - Uncomfortable in social settings - Good motor coordination - Weak verbal and interpersonal skills - See themselves as mechanically and athletically inclined - Stable, natural, persistent - Prefer concrete to abstract problems - Have conventional political and economic goals - Rarely perform creatively in the arts or science - Like to build things with tools - Like to work outdoors - Cool to radical new ideas - Like to work with big, powerful machines - Buy boats, campers, snowmobiles, motorcycles

INVESTIGATIVE - Scientific orientation - Task-oriented, all wrapped up in their work -

Introspective and asocial - Think through rather than act out a problem - Strong need to understand the world - Enjoy ambiguous tasks - Prefer to work independently - Have unconventional attitudes - See themselves as lacking in leadership skills - Confident of their intellectual abilities - Analytical, curious, reserved, independent - Great dislike for repetitive activities - Buy telescopes, calculators, electronic equipment

SOCIAL - Sociable, responsible, humanistic, religious - Like to work in groups - Have verbal and interpersonal skills - Avoid both intellectual problem-solving and physical exertion - Enjoy healing, developing, training, or enlightening others - Understanding, helpful, idealistic - Dislike working with machines or in highly structured situations - Like to discuss philosophic questions - Concerned with the welfare of others - Cooperative, friendly, generous - Attend workshops, other group experiences

ENTERPRISING - Good verbal skills, persuasive - Strong leaders - Avoid work involving long periods of intellectual effort - Strong drive to attain organizational goals - Concerned with power,

status, and leadership - Aggressive, popular, sociable, self-confident - High energy level - Adventuresome, ambitious - Enjoy making things happen - Value money and material possessions - Dislike science and systematic thinking - Buy big cars, nice clothes, country club memberships

CONVENTIONAL - Prefer well-ordered environments - Like systematic, verbal and numerical activities; avoid ambiguous situations and problems - Conscientious, efficient, practical - Identify with power - Value material possessions and status - Orderly, persistent, calm - Adverse to free, unsystematic, exploratory behavior in new areas - Do not seek outside leadership - Stable, controlled, dependable - Most effective at well-defined tasks - Save money, buy conservatively

ARTISTIC - Like art, music, drama, other creative interests - Prefer free, unstructured situations - Impulsive, non-conforming, independent - Adverse to rules - Deal with problems through self-expression in art - Value beauty and aesthetic qualities - Expressive, original, intuitive - Like to work in free environments - Like small, intimate groups - Willing to take risks to try something new - Dress in freer styles than other people -

Have need for individualistic expression - Not assertive about own capabilities - Sensitive and emotional - Spend money on art objects–books, paintings, DVD's, CD's

2. CAREER OPPORTUNITIES AWARENESS

Career opportunity awareness is the process of exposing young people to information about the job market, job related skills, the wide variety of jobs and work environments that exist, and the education and training they require. The information learned by participating in career opportunity awareness activities can help young people identify careers of interest, learn how they can prepare for them, and help them match their interests, personality and abilities to careers. Youth service professionals can play a critical role in increasing the career opportunity awareness of all youth, both by developing learning activities and by engaging local employers to support those activities.

There are many strategies that youth service professionals can use to deepen the career opportunity awareness of youth. Youth can:

- **Review basic information** about a wide variety of careers. Provide materials (such as excerpts from professional magazines, newspapers and other written materials) and plan structured, guided discussions or activities. For youth with reading challenges, provide alternate

formats for information that they can use (such as electronic, large-print, Braille or audio formats). For example, youth could read an article about a birth at the zoo and discuss: what it would be like to work there, the various types of zoo jobs, and the education required. (Th is could be followed by a "behind the scenes" visit to the zoo or a nearby veterinarian.)

• **Explore careers and the labor market using the Internet.** There are a wealth of resources that provide information on careers and the education and training required for entry-level work. Numerous websites can provide information about the job market, careers that will be in demand in the future, sources of education and training, and professional organizations.

• **Visit different workplaces** and talk with the individuals performing the work. You might be able to coordinate this activity through your chamber of commerce, a professional association or other employer-led organizations. For example, youth could tour a cable company and visit all the

departments (customer accounts, technical support, installation and engineering), learning about work settings, required attire, educational requirements, pay scales and benefi ts.

• **Invite guest speakers** to provide information about diff erent careers, guidance in planning for them, and to discuss the skills needed for future success. Guest speakers can come to your site with sample applications, job descriptions and materials for hands-on learning. For example, a hospital human resource manager could talk about all the divisions (transportation, billing, cafeteria, pharmacy, administrative, nursing, radiology and physical/occupational therapy), application requirements, career paths, benefi ts, typical workdays and salaries at a hospital.

• **Arrange informational interviews** with individuals who do a job of interest, and help youth to develop questions that will help them guide their decision about how well their skills match with the job requirements. After the interview, discuss their perceptions and the

realities of the job and help them identify what they liked and didn't like about the job, as well as related types of jobs that they might like to explore.

The interaction of local employers with youth can make a real difference in the career opportunity awareness of those youth. Representatives of local businesses can expose youth to various career paths, teach essential work readiness skills, and help youth understand the educational requirements and work environments related to specifi c occupations. You may contact business leaders through a local chamber of commerce, as well as industry associations.

Local employers can be engaged to support efforts to deepen youths' career opportunity awareness by:

- Providing written materials (about their company, its place in an industry, and the kinds of employment it off ers) for reading activities with youth.

- Providing sample applications and performance reviews for hands-on practice.

• Hosting site visits at their workplaces.

• Serving as guest speakers.

• Participating in informational or mock interviews with young people

Careers Expo/Market

Due to a large of new programs addresed to young people, there are organized a lot of career market events. We think it's important that the students maximise the opportunity offered by a Careers Expo/Market to gather information about career pathways, education and training, and job opportunities.

In order for students to gain value from a careers and training expo or careers market, they need to know:

- what the expo or market is about, and why they are going;
- the information they will be able to access at the expo or market; and
- how and from whom they can get this information.

Ideally, a visit to the expo or market should be part of a comprehensive career education

program. If this is not the case, a preparation program for students before the visit to the expo or market is strongly recommended.

Accompanying teachers should be briefed about the Expo and given guidelines on what they can do to help students gain the maximum benefits from their visit.

Before the Expo:

1. students could brainstorm ideas about how to gain information about jobs and work opportunities. They should include:

- accessing information from the internet
- talking to people - parents, friends, teachers, careers coordinators, student counsellors, employers, people who do the job;
- reading information on courses and occupations – the *Job guide*, newspaper advertisements and articles, company brochures, tertiary institution handbooks,
- contacting or visiting a Career Information Centre;
- experiencing the job, e.g. work experience, work placement, part-time work.

2. Students discuss what a Careers Expo is about

and the benefits for themselves including:

- an opportunity to gain occupational and training information that is directly useful for themselves;
- many different employers, education and training providers and occupations are represented;
- a broad range of information is in the same place at the same time;
- information is presented in several ways – via brochures and printed material, videos and visual displays, practical displays and explanations by representatives who can answer questions; and
- information provided should be accurate and up-to-date.

3. Students generate a list of occupations in which they are interested. Ideally, this list should not be too long, but there should be a few options. Students who have no idea, or are undecided should be encouraged to talk to careers coordinators, teachers, parents or other significant adults before attending the market.

4. Students fill in their chosen career titles on the *Expo worksheet* (they may use more than one if they have more than two jobs to explore). They

complete some information for their Expo worksheet before attending. Students who have been able to answer all questions ahead of time could be encouraged to find different information or explore other careers. For example, they could look for more detailed information about employment and training opportunities.

Student Expo preparation

Questions about the career	**Career 1**
What subjects do I need to study at school?	
What qualifications are required?	
What is the best thing about this job?	
What is the worst thing about this job?	
What is the average starting salary for this job?	

What special skills and abilities are needed?	
Is there opportunity for promotion?	
What related jobs are there in this area?	
My questions: 1	
2	
3	

At the Expo

1. Assist students to develop a list of exhibitors they think they should visit to gain information about the careers they want to research.

2. Assist students to 'interpret' the map and decide which employers or organisations can provide the information they require;

3. Watch for students who lack the confidence to approach adults and ask questions and help them where necessary.

4. Approach groups of students and check that each person is finding what he/she needs.

Post Expo program

A good program should include some kind of 'debriefing' following the visit to the Expo. Teachers can use the *Expo follow up* sheet or discuss the following questions with the class:

- Who felt that the information they gained confirmed their choice(s) of occupation(s)?
- Who changed their mind about their chosen occupational choice, and why?
- Who found out about new jobs that they had not previously considered? What were they?
- What requirements did most employers expect school leavers to meet?
- Do students prefer employment in some organisations over others? If so, why?
- What were some positive features about the jobs investigated?
- What were some negative features associated with the jobs investigated?
- Who has not yet managed to get all of the information required about their occupational

interest? What can they do about this?

- Who still has no ideas about occupations that could be of interest to them? What can they do about this?
- Which occupations or training options would they like to see at the market, but were not represented?

Expo to dos

What to do at the Careers expo or market

Maps of the expo or market and information brochures are usually provided. These give details of employers and organisations who are represented, and their location and/or booth number. Use this information to answer the following.

The organisations I need to find are:

Career	Organisation to visit	Booth number

Tip 1 Collect business cards from the people you talk to so you can contact them later if you need to.

Tip 2 Only collect brochures that will have information that you may need later. Too many brochures can be confusing.

Ask the questions you have about the careers you are interested in.

- What subjects do I need to study at school?
- What qualifications are required?
- What is the best thing about this job?

- What is the worst thing about this job?
- What is the average starting salary for this job?
- What special skills and abilities are needed?
- Is there opportunity for promotion?
- What related jobs are there in this area?

My questions:

1

2

3

Expo follow up

The person/people that helped me the most at the Expo was/were:

_____

_____

My career choices have been confirmed by the people I spoke to. YES or NO

_____

I have changed my mind about my career choice because:

New jobs I found out about were:

Most employers expect school leavers to have:

The best things about the jobs I investigated were:

The worst things about the jobs I investigated were:

_____

_____

I got the information I needed about the careers I am interested in.YES or NO

(If NO) I need to find out about:

_____

_____

Future Careers Expos should include more careers and training information about:

_____

Tips for accompanying teachers

Those teachers who take groups of student to careers markets or Expos can help students to gain maximum benefits from their attendance by:

- assisting students to develop a list of exhibitors they think they should visit to gain information about the careers they want to research;
- assisting students to 'interpret' the map and decide which employers or organisations can provide the information they require; and
- watching for students who lack the confidence to approach adults and ask questions and help them where necessary.

Some students may be too attached to their peer

group to separate and get their own individual information. Approaching groups and checking that each person is finding what he/she needs is often useful.

3. TAKING DECISIONS

THEORETICAL BACKGROUND

Career choice - Career orientation

In our understanding career choice means that we choose a profession or activity, from available possibilities, corresponding to our aims that enables us to carry out work entailing value for both the society and ourselves. The career choice

is an inter-active process between the individual and his environment, which leads to people doing varying professional activities. One may select the activities requiring professional knowledge, and this will be one's future profession. The process of career choice ends with a decision and the young person starts his studies preparing for the professional activity. The work place may be chosen on completion of general education, but it usually happens after finishing vocational education.

Choice is an important element of the process

The word choose is derived from an activity expressed with verb, which means that somebody chooses somebody or something, from among two or more possibilities. It also means the range of available possibilities from which we choose always affects the choice. The process itself entails several senses, a kind of emotional approach, certain determination, even the independence manifesting itself in the decision.

1. Definition of the present situation of the person in search of career (job) includes the questions themselves to which the answers must be found. These are the questions: Where

am I? Where do I stand? What have I achieved? The subject matter of this is provided by the analysis of previous career expectations, ideas discussed.

2. Young people coming from school usually have a developed image of themselves, which either influences or impedes the choice of career. The image may be under-developed to such an extent that the lack of proper self-definition makes the choice harder.

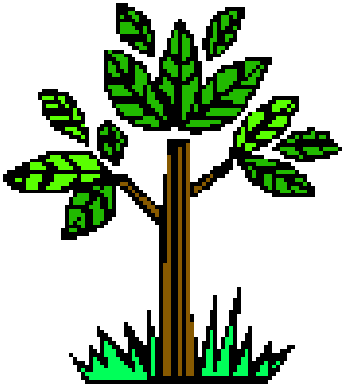
3. The setting of objectives: What expectations and desires are characteristic of the young person, and what are the ones for which he is willing to make effort. The answer to the question: What do we want to achieve? Is sought.

4. Chances of solution: Having determined the needs based on self-knowledge, the range of possibilities, in a broad sense, must be discovered and mapped. Development of information-based career plans in several versions. Answering the question Which direction shall I go to? With concrete steps.

5. Decision – determination: The personality chooses using previous experiences in decision making. I'll start! I'll Try! These are my plans! - situation.

EXERCISES

THE FAMILY TREE



You have surely heard of families that carefully collect the souvenirs, various documents, letters related to their family. If needed, they can also write the history of the family. A family's history does also involve what the profession of the family members was and they achieved in those professions.

Traditionally, the history of a family is depicted in a so-called family tree. However, we have drawn the tree below to show the members of your family.

Having completed the tree, note each member's

profession too. Write the highest level degree too next to the professions. If you can, ask for the help of your parents.

If you wish, you can continue drawing the tree, and can indicate the professions and qualifications of further relatives.

ME

my brothers or sisters	my brothers or sisters
my FATHER	my MOTHER
fathers' brothers and sisters	mother's brothers and sisters
GRANDFATHER GRANDMOTHER	GRANDFATHER GRANDMOTHER

My grandparents:

.....

.....

.....
.....

My parents:

.....
.....
.....
.....

My brothers and sisters:

.....
.....
.....
.....

Other members of my family:

.....
.....
.....
.....

1. Count the number of professions that you have found in your family. What are these?

.....

.....
.....
.....

2. Write also down how many types of school they went to.

.....
.....
.....
.....

3. Can you find members of your family with the same profession? What is this profession?

.....
.....
.....
.....

4. How many similar professions could you find? And how many family members had the same profession?

The number of similar professions:

.....

The number of family members with the same profession:

.....

5. Could you find related professions? What do you think are their related professions?

……
……
……
……

6. Is there somebody in your family who became well-known and publicly honoured through their profession? (You can also write relatives who are no longer alive.)

Yes – no

What is (was) his/her profession?

…….

What made him/her well-known, publicly honoured?

……

7. Look at again the family tree and think about if there is a profession in it that you like?

Yes, because

……

No, because

.....

8. Is there a profession there that would be pleased to choose, however, it is no longer possible to study it? Namely:
   - today there is no longer such a profession existing,
   - the school where I could study it is very far,
   - I should live in a boarding school, but I do not really feel like going there,
   - my school achievement is poor,
   - there are financial reasons for it,
   - there is another reason, namely:

.....
.....
... .

9. Summarise what you have learned about the professional history of your family.

.....
.....
.....
.....
.....

.....
.....
.....

ACTIVITIES THAT I LIKE TO DO

The group leader distributes pieces of paper. Throughout the introduction several activities that you like doing were mentioned. Now I would like to ask you to write more activities that you like to do on the middle of this paper (*distribution of pieces of paper or laying them of the table)*. I have thought of 10-15 activities *(the group leader is writing too!).*

1 .....
2 .....
3 .....
4 .....
5 .....
6 .....
7 .....
8 .....
9 .....
10 .....
11 .....
12 .....

13 .....
14 .....
15 .....

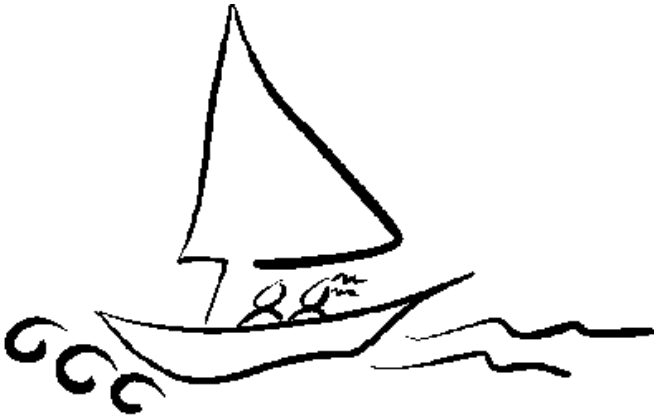
1. Are you ready? I would be pleased to hear what you have written. *(One or two activities must be listened to from everybody's list!)*

2. I would like to ask you to tell me a few from your activities that you would like to be put on the board! *(All the ideas are written on the board.)* Let's see if there are activities here that several of you like to do!*(Collecting)*These are the favoured activities of our group!

3. Let us return a little to our individual lists. I would like to ask you to put a letter "A" on the right of the activity that you like to do alone, and write a letter "T" on the left of the activity if you like to it together with others. - I believe that there are activities that you like to do both alone and together with others. Naturally, write both of the letters next to these.

When you are ready, I would like to ask you to add up in your list the number of activities that like to do alone, that you like to do together with others, and the ones that you like to do in both ways!

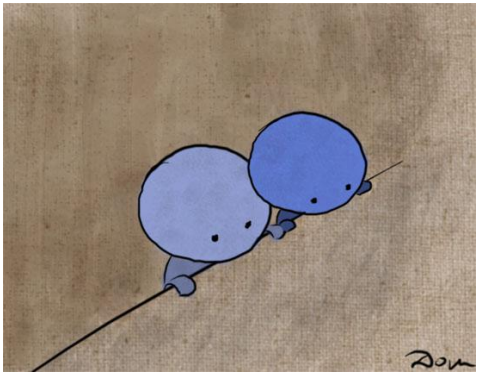
We would be pleased to hear what your results are of the activities done alone and together with others.



MY GAMES

The group should collect games that they played several times before. If possible, the group leader should tell a story of his favourite game that should refer to some physical activity, e.g. cooking, washing, washing up, repairing clocks, bicycles, etc.

OBSERVING SOMETHING



Group members form pairs, stand opposite each other and talk about the "other's" shoes for one minute each, then about the weather for one minute each, and finally about the colour of the others eyes for 1 minute each.

The group leader indicates changes of turn by clapping.

The objective of the exercise is that group members learn to listen to each other and to communicate.

MY APTITUDES

Aptitudes, in the world labour, are similarly interpreted as in sports. There is almost a 'jargon' evolved within a profession of the types of skills that are needed. Below you will see a fairly often used aptitude list.

INTERPRETATION OF APTITUDES

Aptitude of verbal expression: this is an aptitude that enables you to use the words in an individual way. It has got a written and an oral version. In both of them, we use a wide range of words in an individual way.

Arithmetic aptitude: this is an aptitude with help of which you can differentiate between amounts. With this aptitude you can also make simple calculations, e.g. adding up, dividing in head or in writing.

Spatial thinking aptitude: this is the aptitude that enables you to find your way in a city or a forest. This aptitude helps you to imagine information that you see in flush, in space.

Physical capacity: this is an aptitude that helps you display strength or remain in the same position with your body for a longer period of time.

Aptitude in establishing contact: this is the aptitude that helps you speak with ease with another person, turn to and listen to others.

Manual skills: manual skills represent an aptitude with which you can assemble, shape or change objects.

Rank yourselves according to the list. What are the 2-3 aptitudes that you are good at, what are the ones that you find yourself particularly good at, and which remains in the middle.

- Aptitude of verbal expression
- Arithmetic aptitude
- Spatial thinking aptitude
- Physical capacity
- Aptitude in establishing contact
- Manual skills

1. .....
2. .....

3. .....
4. .....

5. ……..
6. ……..

DRAWING GROUP RANKING ON ESTIMATION

Rank the best aptitudes of the group members.

The group leader, based on collecting, determines the strengths of the group.

MY BEST APTITUDES

Let's make pairs according to what we consider our strengths. Those who consider the same aptitudes as their strengths, should sit together and discuss why they think so.

CAREER POKER GAME

Group members mention careers, and continue with the last letter of the previous career. One may also "say no bid".

The winner gets a prize.

ACTIVITY + CAREER SEARCH

The group leader bring into the classroom, in the form of lists, all available training possibilities available in the surrounding area.

Group members should form two groups out of their most beloved 5-10 activities (*15 Activities that I Like to Do*) that they think belong together and then look for careers going with them.

Small groups are recommended, so that members can help each other. In case it is not achieved to find 3 persons along the same grouping, the group leader, according to fellow-feeling, helps making the small group.

The aim of the exercise is that participants search for careers with reference to themselves.

In work sheet (*15 Activities that I Like to Do*) you gathered activities that you would like to do.

Try to categorise these activities. Make at least two groups!

Activities:

Group A:

Group B:

Gather careers where, in your opinion, these activities are often repeated.

……..

……..

……..

……..

Think about whether you like these careers.

……..

……..

……..

Choose at least three from your favourite activities (gathered in exercise *15 Activities that I Like to Do*) that you would like to do often and would be pleased about. Write the three activities on the line below:

1. .....

2. .....

3. .....

Search for the careers where these activities (or at least one of them) can be found often.

.....

.....

.....

If similar activities are carried out at acquaintances', relatives', try to find out and guess what the professions of these people are. Write down the name of careers and professions.

.....

.....

.....

OUR CAREER FIELDS

Where would we like to work?The group leader gathers the most frequent career fields. In the gathering he should use the rule of continuous rotation. The most accepted career fields are put

on the board.

WHAT DO I KNOW ABOUT MYSELF?

Filling in the work sheet. Following individual work, group members discuss their choices in small groups.

My career (job) expectation? .....

Up to now I have considered my aptitudes:

+	- my strength
-	- my weakness
+ -	- I cannot tell

- Aptitude of verbal expression

- Arithmetic aptitude
- Spatial thinking aptitude
- Physical capacity
- Aptitude in establishing contact
- Manual skills

My favourite activities:

1. ……

2. ……..

3. ……..

Career fields characteristic of me

1. ……

2. ……..

3. ……..

PANTOMIME

Each pair should perform the profession chosen according to the collected activities. The others should recognise both the profession and the activities.

HOW TO GO ON?

What should I do to achieve my objective?

The group leader gathers ideas from the group members. The result of gathering is fixed. The small groups work from this when making their "Individual plans".

INDIVIDUAL PLAN – 1

What should I do?

……..

……..

Objective:

……..

What?

……..

When?

.....

INDIVIDUAL PLAN – 2

Objective:

.....

.....

Career:

.....

.....

My strengths:

.....

.....

My possibilities:

.....

.....

My uncertainties:

.....

.....

What?

.....

.....

When?

.....

.....

WHAT INFORMATION DO I NEED?

The group leader should listen to the objectives, if possible, group them. He should gather the most important things that need to be done! Analyse why these are the most important ones. Stay always on the level of concreteness. Examples should be mentioned for each thing to be done.

.....

.....

.....

WHERE AND HOW?

The exercises below would like to draw your attention to some characteristic working modes.

From among the different modes of working choose the one most typical of you. To help you, we have listed 5 pairs of opposites. If none of them is typical of you, then try to write a new pair of opposites.

A) In the pairs of opposites underline the one you would prefer to do.

1. in open air/in the room
2. with hard materials/with soft materials
3. solutions on a large scale/meticulous solutions
4. rather with hand/rather with head
5. lots of movement needed/little movement needed

B) Write an example to each of your underlined characteristics with which you justify why the characteristic underlined and the opposite of it is typical of you.

1. Rather in open air, because
.....

Rather in the room, because
.....

2. I prefer to work with hard materials, because
.....

I prefer to work with soft materials, because
.....

3. I rather solve tasks with large scale solutions, because
……..

I rather solve tasks with meticulous solutions, because
……..

4. I prefer to work using my hands, because
……..

I prefer to work using my head, because
……..

5. I prefer to do tasks that require lots of movement, because
……..

I prefer to do tasks that require little movement, because
……..

6. ……..

……..

……..

……..

C) Look for career fields that go with the

characteristics typical of you.

.....

.....

.....

.....

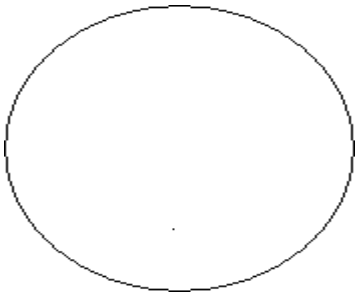
MY OWN OBJECTIVE

What does work mean to me?

.....

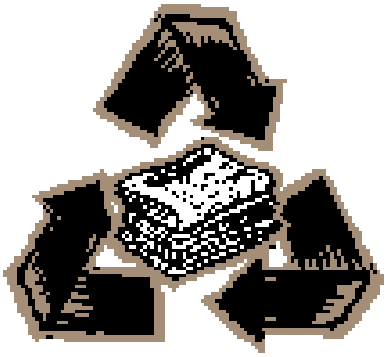
.....

Division of the circle, with concrete names.



HOW TO GO ON?

Questioning around, each group member attempts to answer questions on the development of plans, concrete steps.



DECISION

It is very important to provide youngsters with oppurtunities to understand the importance of decision-making skills, learn to ask a general question concerning a problem, and identify alternatives regarding a problem. The mayor steps in a decision- making procedure are the following:

- define the problem by asking a clear, general question

- lista s many alternatives of action as possible
- identify the criteria or factors that might influence each alternative
- weigh the alternatives on the basis of the criteria
- make a statement of decision

WHAT ARE THE ALTERNATIVES

For each of the following general questions, list as many alternatives as you can think of in three minutes.

What is the best way to get from my house to the local movie theatre?

What can I do with a bicycle wheel?

How could I improve my bedroom?

How could I spend 5000 eu?

What should I do on Saturday evening?

How could I help a new student in the school? What things can I do with a door?

How can I stop my brother from calling me names?

IDENTIFYING CRITERIA

Study the example given, than for each of the following general questions, identify three or four reasonable alternatives and list several criteria you would use to decide wich of these alternatives is the best.

Example: What is the best to use the 50 eu my aunt gave me as a birthday present?

Reasonable alternatives: put the money in bank, buy a present for my mother, buy myself a video game, go to Canada's Wonderland

Criteria: pleasing myself, pleasing others, obtaining immediate satisfaction, obtaining long-term satisfaction, learning to handle money

Exercise:

What is the best way to get from London to Paris?

Reasonable alternatives:

.....
.....
.....

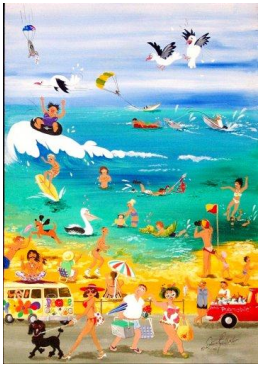
Criteria:
.....
.....
.....

1. What should I do during the summer holidays?

Reasonable alternatives:

.....
.....
.....
.....
.....

Criteria:
.....
.....
.....
.....
.....



DECISION MAKING PROCEDURE

How will I get there?

Consider the following situation: Imagine that you are an executive and you have to go to New York next week. You live in Washington. You are trying to decide how to get there.

Question: What is the best way to get to New York?

Alternatives: drive my car, rent a car, go by bus, go by train, hitchhike, go by airplane, walk, rent a taxi

Criteria: in collecting the information about each alternative, you would note factors such as cost, time, safety, convenience, speed. These factors would emerge as the important considerations to be used to judge the alternatives.

Weighing alternatives: before picking the best alternative, you must check each criterion against each alternative to decide wich gives the best answer to the question.

Statement of decision: You select the alternative that best answers the questions and write the

reasons for your choice. The best choice may be the one with the most advantages (+ signs) and the fewest disadvantages (- signs), assuming that all the criteria are of equal importance.

Question:
.....
.....
.....

		Alternatives							
		my car	rented car						
Criteria	cost								
	time								
	convenience								

Statement of decision:

.....
.....
.....

Reasons for choice:
.....
.....
.....

4. TRANSITION PLANNING

In the introduction part, we spoke about the chaos theory in career development. The individuals are understood as complex dynamic systems, and career can be understood as an emergent property of the interaction of individuals as systems with the rest of the world, which is also understood in terms of being multiple embedded systems (for a taxonomy of such systems refer to Patton & McMahon, 1999).

The defining characteristic of chaotic systems is sensitivity to change {Lorenz, 1993)--the famous butterfly effect, which has seeped into popular consciousness through films such as Sliding Doors (Rraithwaitc, Horburg, Pollack, & Howitt, 1998) and The Butterfly Effect (Bender et ah, 2004).

The implication of this sensitivity to change is that complex dynamic systems arc subject to phase shifts, points at which the system can transform,

as when water freezes and becomes ice. As a consequence of the complexity of such systems, predicting such change, or phase shifts, is difficult and often impossible. As a result, chaotic systems may sometimes seem to be subject to randomness, when in fact what is being demonstrated is simply unpredictability resulting from complexity.

The most familiar chaotic system is the weather. It exhibits overall patterns that are discerned as climates and seasons; however, the precise prediction of the weather conditions at a particular place at a specific time beyond a period of about 7 days becomes, at best, probabilistic and, at worst, simply chance. In a similar way, chaotic systems demonstrate order in the form of general patterns of functioning but, at the same time, may be unpredictable at any particular moment.

Because CTC integrates both order and stability

and chance and change, the convergent and emergent perspectives are not viewed as competing but rather as complementary ways to understand human experience and to take purposive action. Counselors and their clients can use either or both perspectives, depending on the issue identified as germane to individuals' career development. Sometimes this may mean that decision makers need help in moving from one perspective to the other, Such shifts may need to occur in a recycling manner several times during the course of counseling at each point at which clients begin to feel "stuck" in the decision-making process.

(a) Indecisive clients. Shifts in perspective might be needed when possibilities have to be refined into possible decisions and actions. This requires a "possibilities to probabilities" shift. This situation illustrates the perennial counseling

problem of client indecisiveness. Indecisive clients usually do not have problems generating possibilities; their problem is choosing among alternatives. After having made a choice, the implementation of that choice and the likely strategic counseling challenges can be identified through the use of the new career decision-making perspective.

Clients' consideration of the many consequences of such choices sometimes paralyzes their ability to choose. Newell (2005) has argued that people use evidence accrual methods in decision making and that, in doing so, they vary in the amount of evidence they require before making a decision. Some clients may need to be encouraged to start developing and using the strategies of the convergent perspective. As options are gradually whittled down to several alternatives, then a further perspective shift from probabilities to possibilities may be required. At this point, clients

may need to be encouraged to creatively consider in what ways several attractive options might be combined. For example, someone trying to decide between engineering and medicine could be encouraged to explore options involving the construction and development of medical technology, the safety dimensions of industrial design, or even ergonomics.

Very often, a client who seeks more information before making a decision will search externally for this information, rather than looking inward and using creativity and imagination to think through potential scenarios and their potential to meet his or her needs. Traditional job search advice (e.g., Bright, 2003) has tended to focus on external exploration of relevant labor market information (convergent perspective). The emergent perspective complements this by emphasizing the importance of developing new realities through imagination, metaphor, and creativity (e.g.,

Amundson, 2003a; Ibarra, 2003).

(b) Clients in a stale of indecision. Alternatively, counselors often have clients who are in a state of indecision. Such clients often cannot see any alternatives. They will frequently say that they have no options. For example, a client who has worked in middle management in a specialized manufacturing organization for the last 15 years and who has been laid off may think that his or her skills are so narrow that no one else would want to employ him or her, especially after having submitted 20 or 30 job applications and not receiving any job offers. Such clients need to be encouraged to engage in a convergent to divergent perspective shift and to start using "possibilities" thinking to explore, discover, and create possibilities to consider, refine, restructure, and combine. Preoccupations (Savickas, 1997) and "sweet spots" (i.e., the intersection of a person's uniqueness, purposes, and capacities;

Lucado, 2005) may need to be identified and explored. Meaning, purpose, and passion may need to be reviewed and deeply thought through (Pryor & Bright, 2004). For example, if the unemployed manufacturing manager of our example decided, as a consequence of this change of perspective, to initiate a major life transition (called a phase shift in CTC), then this might in turn require an emergent to convergent perspective shift as the manager endeavored to decide on the new location for the family and the training course required to become, for example, a library technician.

Convergent and emergent perspective change. A chaos theory conceptualization of reality posits change as an integral component of the way systems function. Change often restructures the dynamics of systems. Such change can be abrupt or gradual, linear or nonlinear, planned or unplanned. In fact, most humans experience all

these types of change in every conceivable combination during their life. Most career counseling is about change (Amundson, 2003a). Therefore, career counselors are in the business of encouraging appropriate, helpful, and positive change for their clients. Using convergent and divergent perspectives on career decision making, four possible change strategies can be outlined in terms of the land of issues that counselors might want to stimulate their clients to explore. In the next section we have provided a list of the issues and also some of the questions that counselors can use to stimulate such discussion.

Four Strategies to Stimulate Clients' Perspective Change

1. Beating the Odds

Counseling Issues and Questions: Can you describe some of the ways that people "beat the

odds" when facing challenging situations? How is it that they are able to overcome what seem to be insurmountable odds? Can you think of any times in your past when your efforts have "beaten the odds" in accomplishing something? What could you learn from that experience?

2. Improving the Odds

Counseling Issues and Questions: Can you describe some of the ways that people "improve their odds" when facing challenging situations? How is it that they are able to position themselves in a way that makes for a greater likelihood of success? Can you think of any times in your past when your efforts have "improved the odds" of something you wanted to happen? What could you learn from that experience?

3. More Than Chance

Counseling Issues and Questions: Can you

describe some situations in which people focus too much on "luck" and do not recognize their own part in influencing life and career events? How could they become more aware of their own capacity and also learn to use these strategies in a systematic fashion? Can you think of any times in your past when you have relied on luck or blamed circumstances when you could have taken positive action but did not? What could you learn from that experience?

4. Becoming Realistic

Counseling Issues and Questions: Can you think of times when people are unrealistic about possibilities? What are some of the ways that they could become more realistic about their options? Can you think of any times in your past when you have totally overestimated or underestimated the possibilities of something happening? What could you learn from that experience?

Furthermore, although this handbook focuses primarily on career development counseling strategies, we thought it would assist counselors it we provided an example of a specific counseling technique that illustrates how a client's possibility thinking might be encouraged. This technique can be used to generate new alternatives to an option already being considered. It may also be useful for contingency planning by assisting clients to think about the most probable unplanned events and how they might need to respond to them. (See the section bellow for the description of this counseling technique.)

Possibility Thinking Example: The "Wotif" Exercise

This exercise is designed to encourage students who are already considering a particular vocational option (Plan A) to develop Plans B, C, and D--that is, alternative options or contingency

plans in case circumstances dictate that their original goal becomes unfeasible. "Wotif" stands for "What if," as in "What if the sky fell in?" or "What if you got better grades than expected?"

Procedure: Introduce the exercise with a discussion of "Unplanned Events in Careers." Start by citing Bright, Pryor, and Harpham (2005), who reported that around 70% of young people said that an unplanned event had significantly influenced their career plans.

If in a group setting, ask students to suggest chance events that could influence a career (or that have influenced either their own life or the life of people they know or know about). Record these suggestions on a whiteboard using a mind mapping technique (see Figure 1).

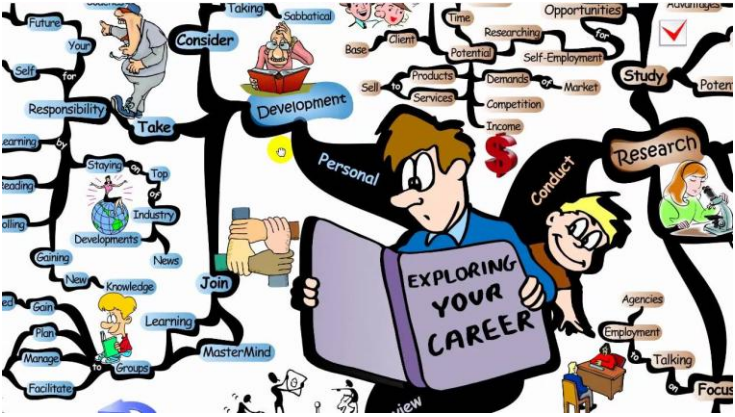


Figure 1. Mind mapping model

If the students fail to generate many examples, try these prompts (the percentages refer to the proportion of young people who report these types of chance events and are the results of research by Bright et al., 2005): a personal or work relationship (44%), previous work or social experiences (60%), barriers to your previous career plan (36%), an injury or health problem (11%), unintended exposure to a type of work or activity that you found interesting (43%), unintended exposure to a type of work or activity

that you did not enjoy (33%), a major change of residence over which you had little or no control (11%), or any other unplanned event (10%).

When a list has been generated, ask the students if they have any personal experience of any of those events. If so, ask them what happened in the aftermath of the event. What did they learn from the event?

Step 1. Get each student to identify a personal career goal. If they cannot do this, suggest an example, such as "I want a sales traineeship," "I want to study commerce at a university," or "I want to start an apprenticeship in plumbing or hairdressing."

Step 2. Now ask the students to think "What if, , ? and fill in the blank with one of the chance events previously generated.

Step 3. Then ask them the following:

A. How would things be changed as a result of this event?

B. What other career goals could be achieved given that this change occurred?

C. How could such alternative goals be pursued and implemented?

Repeat Steps 1, 2, and 3 to generate Plans B, C, and D as ways to practice dealing with unpredictability.

Skills in demand

In a transition plan, for students, it might be necessary to explore skill shortage areas and job prospects, to develop an understanding of the skills shortage area. This includes the different types of shortages that currently exist and how to develop the understandings needed to interpret the skills shortage information.

Activities

1. Discuss the area of skills shortages with the students, including:

- Skills shortages occur when the demand for a particular type of worker exceeds supply of those workers.
- Occupations may be in shortage in some geographical areas and not others.
- Skills shortages usually involve skills that require a significant amount of training, education and/or experience.
- Changes in technology that require workers to have different skills can result in skills shortage.
- Changes in the labour market because of economic change can result in skills shortage.

2. Discuss how skills in demand can benefit job seekers

- If a skill is in demand there will be more vacancies for people with that skill.
- Wages and conditions may be better if your skills are in demand.
- There may be better training opportunities for jobs with skills shortages.

3. Students complete the *Skills shortages* handout and discuss

4. Students complete the *Careers* handout using web based resources, newspaper classifieds and other information sources.

Note: Teachers may want to use their own list of careers instead of the handout or students could select careers they want to explore.

Skills shortages

When there aren't enough people with the specialist skills that are needed to do a particular kind of work, the result is known as a skill in demand or skill shortage.

There are many reasons why skills can be in demand and the kind of skills in demand in can vary from place to place.

List reasons why skills shortages can happen

_____

How can skills in demand be useful for job seekers

_____

Careers

Using information about job prospects and skill shortages, complete the table.

Career	Nationally in demand (yes or no)	In demand near where I live (yes or no)	In demand in 5 years (yes or no)	Why?
Mechanic				
Aged care attendant				
Architect				
Driver				
Nurse				
Carpenter				
Bank teller				
Engineer				
Social worker				
Chef				

My predictions

Name and describe a job that does not exist now, but may exist in 10 years time

_____

How do I find out what skills are in demand?

- Look at the numbers of advertisements for a particular job in the classified section of the newspaper
- Explore websites that provide this information
- Explore developing technologies and consider predictions of growth areas in the future

and

Remember

- Just because a skill is in demand, doesn't mean you can automatically get a job in that area. You still need the specialised skills required.
- Areas in demand now, may not be in demand in future. You need to think about whether they will still be in demand when you finish your training.
- When exploring skills shortage information look at how old the data is that is being used to

identify the shortages.

- If you don't have the skills that are in demand, there might be an opportunity to get an entry-level job in a skill-in-demand field. This will let you develop your skills on the job.
- Don't choose a skill in demand just because it's in demand. You need to consider jobs that actually interest you.

5. CAREER MANAGEMENT

Key Concepts

- Career anchors
- Career ladders
- Career paths
- Portfolio career
- Career dynamics
- Career management
- Career planning
- Protean career

Learning outcomes

On completing this chapter you should be able to define these key concepts. You should also know about:

- The aims of career management
- Career development strategy

•Career management policies

•Career stages

•Career management activities

•Self-managedcareers

Introduction

Career management is an aspect of talent management but deserves to be considered separately as an important activity in its own right. This chapter starts with a definition ofcareer management and its aims. It then describes the frame work of career planning–the stages that careers can follow within an organization and the dynamics that govern career progression. The next section of the chapter covers career management activities, and the chapter ends with a discussion of how people can manage their own careers with help, as required, from the organization.

Career management is the combination of structured planning and the active management choice of one's own professional career. The outcome of successful career management should include personal fulfillment, work/life balance,

goal achievement and financial security.

A career includes all types of employment ranging from semi-skilled through skilled, and semi professional to professional. Careers have often been restricted to an employment commitment to a single trade skill, profession or business firm for the entire working life of a person. In recent years, however, a career now includes changes or modifications in employment during the foreseeable future.

The following classification system with minor variations is widely used:

Development of overall goals and objectives,

Development of a strategy (a general means to accomplish the selected goals/ objectives),

Development of the specific means (policies, rules, procedures and activities) to implement the strategy, and

Systematic evaluation of the progress toward the achievement of the selected goals/ objectives to modify the strategy, if necessary.

Career management defined

Career management is concerned with the provision of opportunities for people to develop their abilities and their careers in order to ensure that the organization has the flow of talent it needs and to satisfy their own aspirations. It is about integrating the needs of the organization with the needs of the individual.

An important part of career management is career planning, which shapes the progression of individuals within an organization in accordance with assessments of organizational needs, defined employee success profiles and the performance, potential and preferences of individ-ual members of the enterprise. But career management is also concerned with career counselling to help people develop their careers to their advantage as well as that of the organization.

Aims

For the organization the aim of career management is to meet the objectives of its talent man-agement policies, which are to ensure that there is a talent flow that creates and maintains the required talent pool. For employees the aims of career management policies are: 1) to give them the guidance, support and

encouragement they need to fulfil their potential and achieve a successful career with the organization in tune with their talents and ambitions, and 2) to provide those with promise a sequence of experience and learning activities that will equip them for whatever level of responsibility they have the ability to reach.

Career management calls for an approach that explicitly takes into account both organizational needs and employee interests. It calls for creativity in identifying ways to provide development opportunities. Career management policies and practices are best based on an understanding of the stages through which careers progress in organizations.

The career management process begins with setting goals/objectives. A relatively specific goal/ objective must be formulated. This task may be quite difficult when the individual lacks knowledge of career opportunities and/or is not fully aware of their talents and abilities. However, the entire career management process is based on the establishment of defined goals/ objectives whether specific or general in nature. Utilizing career assessments may be a critical step in

identifying opportunities and career paths that most resonate with someone. Career assessments can range from quick and informal to more indepth. Regardless of the ones you use, you will need to evaluate them. Most assessments found today for free (although good) do not offer an in-depth evaluation.

The time horizon for the achievement of the selected goals or objectives - short term, medium term or long term - will have a major influence on their formulation.

1. Short-term goals (one or two years) are usually specific and limited in scope. Short-term goals are easier to formulate. Make sure they are achievable and relate to your longer term career goals.

2. Intermediate goals (3 to 20 years) tend to be less specific and more open ended than short-term goals. Both intermediate and long-term goals are more difficult to formulate than short-term goals because there are so many unknowns about the future.

3. Long-term goals (Over 20 years), of course, are the most fluid of all. Lack of life experience

and knowledge about potential opportunities and pitfalls make the formulation of long-term goals/objectives very difficult. Long-range goals/objectives, however, may be easily modified as additional information is received without a great loss of career efforts because of experience/knowledge transfer from one career to another.

4. Making career choices and decisions – the traditional focus of careers interventions. The changed nature of work means that individuals may now have to revisit this process more frequently now and in the future, more than in the past.

5. Managing the organizational career – concerns the career management tasks of individuals within the workplace, such as decision-making, life-stage transitions, dealing with stress etc.

6. Managing 'boundaryless' careers – refers to skills needed by workers whose employment is beyond the boundaries of a single organization, a workstyle common among, for example, artists and designers.

7. Taking control of one's personal development –

as employers take less responsibility, employees need to take control of their own development in order to maintain and enhance their employability.

Career Planning

Career planning is a subset of career management. Career planning applies the concepts of Strategic planning and Marketing to taking charge of one's professional future. Career is an ongoing process and so it needs to be assessed on continuous basis. This process of re-assessing individual learning and development over a period of time is called Career Planning. It consists of 4 steps that are essential for proper and complete planning.

Importance of career planning

It is important to come up with your career planning as it gives you the much needed direction and makes it clear there where you see yourself in future. It makes you aware of your strength and weaknesses and the skills and knowledge that are required to achieve your goals in future.

A large proportion of our life is spent in achieving our career goals, thus it is very important to make sure that right steps were taken and correct planning was done in the early years of your life. There are very few lucky ones who are born with a clear mind and who knows what they want to do and where they see themselves in life ahead. But majority of us are not sure what we want from life and so it in very important to plan out things. Thus career planning is what gives your career and in some way your life, true meaning and purpose.

Process of career planning

The process of career planning is also known as career development stages and career development model. These steps help you in planning your career and deciding about your future.

Self-assessment

Self-assessment is a process that helps you in assessing your skills, your potential, our strengths and your ability to fulfill your aims. As the name of the step suggest, you assess yourself and then, based on your analyses and keeping your

strengths and weaknesses in mind, you draft your future plan. By drafting your future plan we mean that executing this step helps you to finalize the profession and career path you want to choose. Make sure that you choose and finalize more than one career, keep one or two careers in case you decide to roll back. In case the career you chose does not satisfies you or later in time you come to know that this was not meant for you then in that case you must have a backup plan.

Self-development

Once you have self-analyzed yourself, the second step that awaits your attention is to fill the loopholes you have identified in the above step. By this we mean that in this step you have to see that what are the qualities and skills that are required by you to help you achieve your aims and goals. For instance you might decide that you need training or a particular course in a field in order to make you perfect for the profession you have chosen.

It could be that you are interested in painting but you are not much aware of the trends or the knowledge that is required for this field. Or there can be a case where you are interested and much

aware about a profession like teaching but you do not yet know that what is the niche level that is meant for you like and the subjects you can carry off pretty well.

A thorough research self-development

Once you have listed the careers that are favorable in your case and the skills and improvements that are required by you in order to achieve excellence the third step requires you to do an intensive research and see that what that are findings related to career options and the skills that are required to make you champion in that. You research will be looking into following questions:

What is the scope of the career you have chosen?

Will that career pay you off in the future?

Is there room for expansion in that career field?

Come up with action form

Once you have researched the feasibility of the factors that you have finalized in above steps, the next step is to show some action and translate your plans on a piece of page. This step requires

you to make plan as in how you are going to achieve and fulfill the steps you have decided above. The best way to come with an action plan is to come up with small goals for oneself. Once these small goals are achieved, we can see that how much close we are to our main aim and major goal. This small step acts as a path way to the main aim.

Action

Once you are done with small goals and the main aim, the next step remains to start implementing your plans. Keep a very close track of your activities to make sure that you are on the right track and that by following this path you are surely going to achieve you goal

Career Stages

The stages of a career within an organization can be described as a career lifecycle. Hall (1984) set this out as follows.

Career Stages

1. Entry to the organization when the individual can begin the process of self-

directed career planning.

2. Progress within particular areas of work where skills and potential are developed through experience, training, coaching, mentoring and performance manage-ment.

3. Mid-career when some people will still have good career prospects while others may have got as far as they are going to get, or at least feel that they have. It is nec-essary to ensure that these 'plateaued' people do not lose interest at this stage by taking such steps as providing them with cross-functional moves, job rotation, special assignments, recognition and rewards for effective performance, etc.

4. Later career when individuals may have settled down at whatever level they have reached but are beginning to be concerned about the future. They need to be treated with respect as people who are still making a contribution and given oppor-tunities to take on new challenges wherever this is possible. They may also need reassurance about their future with the organization and

what is to happen to them when they leave.

5. End of career with the organization – the possibility of phasing disengagement by being given the chance to work part time for a period before they finally have to go should be considered at thisstage.

Career Dynamics

Career management should be based on an understanding of career dynamics. This is concerned with how careers progress – the ways in which people move through their careers either upwards when they are promoted, or by enlarging or enriching their roles to take on greater responsibilities or make more use of their skills and abilities. The three stages of career progression – expanding, establishing and maturing – are illustrated in Figure 1.1. This also shows how individuals progress or fail to progress at different rates through these stages.

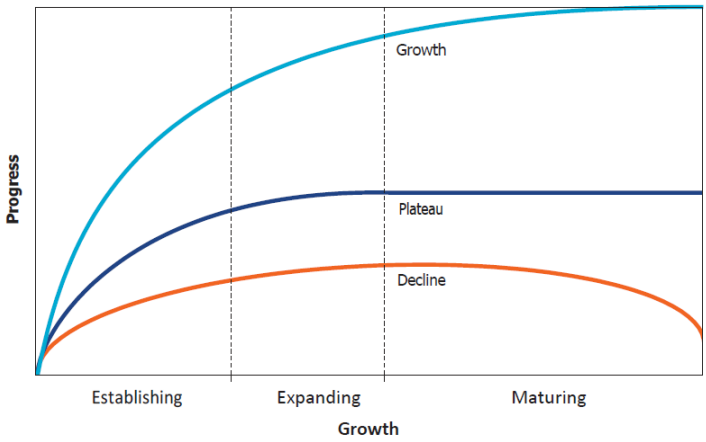


Figure 1.1. Carrier progression curves

Career Development Strategy

A career development strategy might include the following activities:

• a policy of promoting from within wherever possible;

• career routes enabling talented people to move from bottom to top of the organization, or laterally in the firm, as their development and job opportunities take them;

• personal development planning as a major part of the performance management process, in order

to develop each individual's knowledge and skills;

• systems and processes to achieve sharing and development of knowledge (especially tacit) across the firm;

• multi-disciplinary project teams with a shifting membership in order to offer develop-mental opportunities for as wide a range of employees as possible.

Career Management Activities

As described by Hirsh and Carter (2002), career management encompasses recruitment, per-sonal development plans, lateral moves, special assignments at home or abroad, development positions, career bridges, lateral moves and support fo remployee swho want to develop.

Baruch and Peiperl (2000) identified 17 career management practices, and their survey of 194 UK companies established a rank order for their use. The practices are listed below in order, frommostfrequenttoleastfrequentuse.

Career Management Practices

1. Postings regarding internal job openings.
2. Formal education as part of career development.
3. Performance appraisal as a basis for career planning.
4. Career counselling by manager.
5. Lateral moves to create cross-functionalexperience.
6. Career counselling by HR department.
7. Retirement preparation programmes.
8. Succession planning.
9. Formalmentoring.
10. Common career paths.
11. Dual ladder career paths (parallel hierarchy for professional staff).
12. Books and/or pamphlets on career issues.
13. Written personal career planning (as done

bythe organization orpersonally).

14. Assessment centres.
15. Peer appraisal.
16. Career workshops.
17. Upward(subordinate) appraisal.

The Process of Career Management

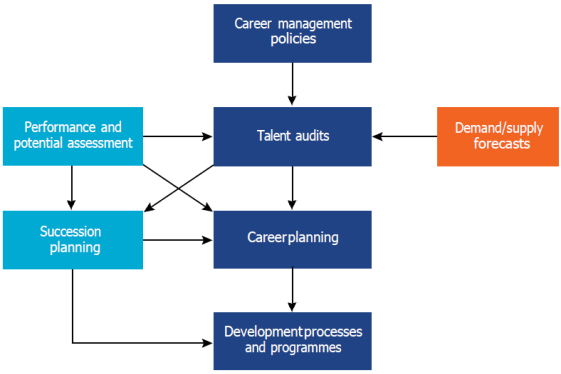


Figure 1.2 The process of career management

Career Management Policies

The organization needs to decide on the extent to which it 'makes or buys' talented people. Should it grow its own talent (a promotion from within

policy) or should it rely on external recruitment (bringing'fresh blood' into the organization)? The policy may be to recruit potentially high performers who will be good at their present job and are rewarded accordingly. If they are really good, they will be promoted and the enterprise will get what it wants. Deliberately to train managers for a future that may never happen is a waste of time. In contrast and less frequently, employers who believe in long-term career planning develop structured approaches to career management. These include elaborate reviews of performance and potential, assess-ment centres to identify talent or confirm that it is there, 'high flyer' schemes and planned job moves in line with a predetermined programme.

There may also be policies for dealing with the 'plateaued' manager who has got so far but will get no further. Some managers in this position may be reconciled to reaching that level but continue to work effectively. Others will become bored, frustrated and unproductive, especially rising stars on the wane. The steps that can be taken to deal with this problem include:

- lateral moves into different functional areas or

specialized subsidiaries, in order to provide new challenges and career breadth;

• temporary assignments and second ments outside the organization;

• appointments as leaders of project teams set up to deal with performance barriers inside the organization such as the slowness of responses to customer complaints.

Talent Audits

These review the stocks of talent available and the flows required by reference to demand and supply forecasts and performance and potential assessments. They provide the basis for succession planning and career planning, as covered later in this section.

Performance and potential a ssessments

The aim of performance and potential assessments is to identify learning and development needs, provide guidance on possible directions in which an individual's career might go, and indicate who has potential for promotion. This information can be obtained from

performance management processes.

Assessment of potential can be carried out formally by managers following a performance review. They may be asked to identify people who have very high potential, some potential or no potential at all. They may also be asked to indicate when individuals will be ready for promotion and how far they are likely to get. The problem with this sort of assessment is that managers find it difficult to forecast the future for the people they are reviewing – good performance in the current job does not guarantee that individuals will be able to cope with wider responsibilities, especially if this involves moving into management, and managers may not necessarily be aware of the qualities required for longer-term promotion. But the organization does need information on those with potential and assessors should be encouraged at least to indicate that this is someone who is not only performing well in the present job but may well perform well in higher-level jobs. This information can identify those who may be nominated to attend development centres which can be used to establish potential and discuss

career plans.

Career Planning

Career planning involves the definition of career paths – the routes people can take to advance their careers within an organization. It uses all the information provided by the organization's assessments of requirements, the assessments of performance and potential and management succession plans, and translates it into the form of individual career development programmes and general arrangements for management development, career counselling and mentoring.

It is possible to define career progression in terms of what people are required to know and be able to do to carry out work to progress up the 'career ladder' (the sequence of jobs at increasing levels of responsibility, which constitute a career). These levels can be described as competency bands. For each band, the competencies needed to achieve a move to that level would be defined to produce a career map incorporating 'aiming points' for individuals, as illustrated in Figure 1.3. People would be made aware of the competency levels they must reach in order to achieve progress in their careers. This would help them to plan their

own development, although support and guidance should be provided by their managers, HR specialists and, if they exist, management development advisers or mentors. The provision of additional experience and training could be arranged as appropriate, but it would be important to clarify what individual employees need to do for themselves if they want to progress within the organization.

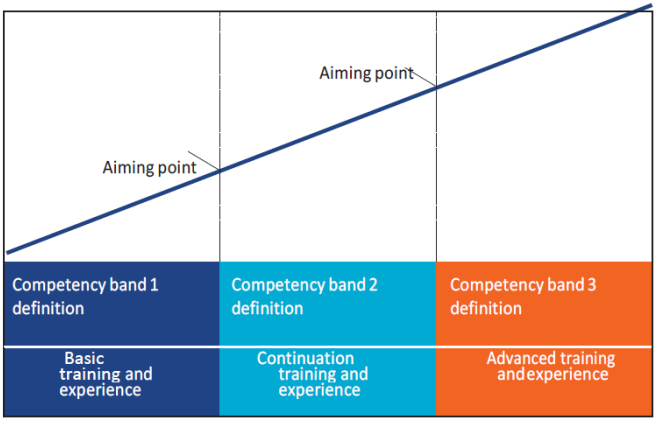


Figure 1.3. Competency band career progression system

As reported by Ready and Conger (2007), at Proctor & Gamble,'destination jobs' are identified for rising stars, which are attainable only if the employee continues to perform, impress and

demonstrate growth potential.

Career family grade structures can define levels of competency in each career family and show career paths upwards within families or between families, as illustrated in Figure 1.4.

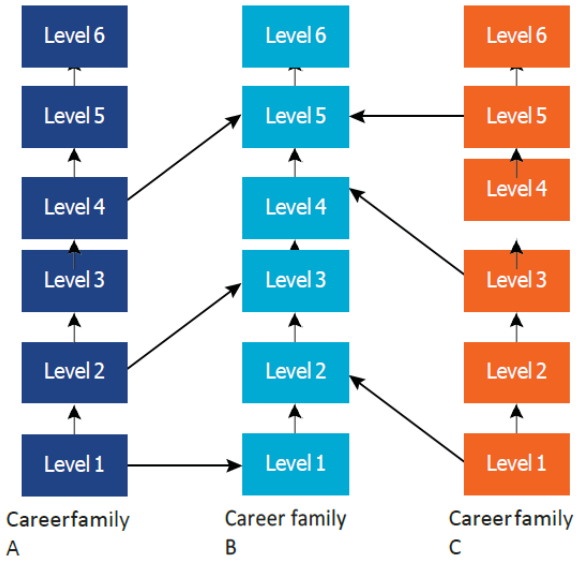


Figure 1.4. Career paths in a career family structure

Formal career planning along these lines may be the ideal but, as noted by Hirsh et al (2000), there has been a shift from managed career moves to more open internal job markets. The

process of internal job application has become the main way in which employees manage their careers.

Self-managed careers

The organization may need to manage careers as part of its talent management and management succession programmes and can provide support and guidance to people with potential. Ultimately, however, it is up to individuals to manage their own careers within and beyond their present organization. Handy (1984) used the term'portfolio career' to describe his fore-cast that people will increasingly change the direction of their careers during the course of their working life. Hall (1996) coined the phrase the 'protean career' in which individuals take responsibility for transforming their career path (the name comes from the Greek god Proteus who could change his shape at will).

Schein (1978) originated the notion of career anchors. He defined them as the self-concept of people consisting of self-perceived talents and abilities, basic values and a sense of motives and needs relating to their careers. As people gain work experience, career anchors evolve and

function as stabilizing forces, hence the metaphor of 'anchor'. His original research in the 1970s showed that most people'sself-concept revolved round the following categories reflecting their needs.

SOURCE REVIEW

Self-concept categories, Schein (1978)

1. Autonomy/independence.
2. Security/stability.
3. Technical-functional competence.
4. General managerial competence.
5. Entrepreneurial creativity.
6. Serviceordedicationtoacause.
7. Pure challenge.
8. Lifestyle.

The original concept of career anchors was developed at a time when jobs were relatively static and career paths within and between organizations were fairly easy to map. But as Schein pointed out in an update of his concept in

1996, jobs are increasingly becoming more dynamic and there is a shift from the provision of 'employment security' to 'employability security'.

Calling on his experience in administering his career anchor self-analysis exercise, Schein claimed that while each of the anchor categories are still valid, they are more difficult to apply as the world of work and organizational structure become more turbulent.

Although the career anchor is designed as a self-analysis tool it can be used by career counsellors within and outside organizations as the basis for discussing career plans and how they can be realized, but it is necessary to consider the changing perceptions of people about their careers. Research on career anchors in a changing business environment based on interviews with 540 managers, carried out by Kniveton (2004), indicated that younger managers were more oriented towards their own skills and what they could contribute, where as older managers were more inclined to be aware of the limitations of their role in the organization. It was stressed that this difference needed to be taken into account by those involved in career planning within

organizations.

Career management- key learning points

The aims of career management

For the organization, the aim of career management is to meet the objectives of its talent management policies, which are to ensure that there is a talent flow that creates and maintains the required talent pool. For employees, the aims of career management policies are to give them the guidance, support and encouragement they need to fulfil their potential and achieve a success-ful career with the organization in tune with their talents and ambitions.

Career stages

- Entry to the organization.
- Progress within particular areas of work.
- Mid-career.
- Later career.
- End of career.

Career management activities

The five most common activities are:

1. Postings regarding internal job openings.
2. Formal education as part of career development.
3. Performance appraisal as a basis for career planning.
4. Career counselling by manager.
5. Lateral moves to create cross-functional experience.

Career management policies

The organization needs to decide on the extent to which it 'makes or buys talented people (it grows from within or recruits from outside). It also needs policies on talent audits and performance and potential assessments.

Self-managed careers

The organization may need to manage careers as part of its talent management and management succession programmes and can provide support

and guidance to people with potential. Ultimately, however, it is up to individuals to manage their own careers within and beyond their present organization.

Questions

1. Drawing upon research findings, how might you use past assessments of an individual's strengths and weaknesses to help clarify their future development?

2. Critically evaluate Schein's concept of career anchors

6. ENTREPRENEURSHIP

CREATIVE – THINKING EXERCISES FOR ENTREPRENEURSHIP CLASS

EXERCISE 1

This exercise is based on art. Works of art and their artists are presented in a matching quiz format for this exercise. The matching format helps to eliminate careless guesses or reluctance to participate since the answers are on the page to jog the students' recollection. This exercise could be used to tie in with performances, exhibits, or other arts events on campus. Between ten and 20 matches typically give the students enough time to focus on the exercise.

Examples of artists and their works for this exercise are as follows: (1) Charles Dickens/A Christmas Carol; (2) Tchaikovsky/The Nutcracker; (3) Jane Austen/Pride and Prejudice; (4) Langston Hughes/Not Without Laughter; (5) Mary Shelley/Frankenstein; (6) Steve Martin/The Jerk; (7) Mozart/The Magic Flute; (8) Rodin/The Thinker; (9) Alice Walker/The Color Purple; (10) Claude Monet/Water Lilies; (11) Louis

Armstrong/Hello, Dolly; (12) Elvis Presley/ Jailhouse Rock.

This exercise could resonate with students who are majoring in the arts (art, music, theater, literature) as well as those majoring in business who may expand their perspective on products and product development.

The first tie to entrepreneurship that the instructor can point out in the arts exercise is that these works of art are products. Artistic innovation is an act of entrepreneurship (Nytch, 2012).

Businesses exist to publish books or songs or to sell paintings or pieces of pottery. Some are craftspeople or artisan businesses. Others are sizeable businesses such as HarperCollins Publishers or Walt Disney movies or Sony Music. Each performance of a ballet, opera, or play is a new product, even if the original work was written decades or centuries ago.

Two of the examples given in the exercise above – Tchaikovsky's "Nutcracker" and Charles Dickens' "A Christmas Carol" – are significant revenue generators for ballet companies and theaters each

winter holiday season. The companies may try to come up with new twists on the performances, and each year's iteration is a new product. But the programs are typically staged each year because of their popularity with audiences and the expectations that the shows will be available as a tradition of the season. Each revival of a Broadway musical or play (e.g., Cats, 42nd Street) is a new product.

An innovation can also be developed as a new spin on an old story, such as the book and musical "Wicked" that offers more details about the story of the characters in "The Wizard of Oz".

There are also many opportunities to provide products needed in the development and presentation of these works of art. Examples of such products or services include costumes, lighting, scenery, and advertising. Theater companies can generate income by renting their costumes to other theater companies or the public. Theaters offer summer workshops for schoolage students to generate revenue from their facilities during the summer break when most theaters are not staging productions. New books and new printings of classic books require

paper, printing, and distribution to bookstores in hard copy.

The digital readers and apps that have been developed for ebooks present new opportunities in books. Ebooks present an interesting example of how products develop when the technology is there to support them and how technology develops when there is demand for it to support new product ideas. This example illustrates the concept of co-evolution of industries (Antonelli, 1998; Geels, 2014). The ebook technology can affect the types of books that are written (i.e., books written for the technology format) and the demand for ebooks can affect innovations in the technology (e.g., readability of screens, etc.).

Entrepreneurial opportunities arise in each of the industries that are co-evolving, and paying attention to one industry can alert an entrepreneur to opportunities in another industry.

Another tie of the arts to entrepreneurship is through advertising and community involvement. If an entrepreneur's target market is likely to also patronize the arts, the business may want to sponsor an event or advertise in the event's printed program. Theaters often accept paid ads

or will exchange advertising space for gifts-in-kind, particularly community theaters. Contributions to the arts can give a business a means for community participation and, perhaps, public relations opportunities (Steyn & Niemann, 2014).

The triple-bottom line is one method that has been suggested for capturing the sustainability and social responsibility concepts in business (Edgeman & Eskildsen, 2014). The triple bottom line encourages a focus on not only profit but also planet and people. The arts can offer a way to support the people element. Specifically, contributions to and support of arts organizations offer an avenue for supporting the community in which a business is located. Such community involvement can have benefits other than just company image. By contributing to the vibrancy of the community through cultural amenities, the company is helping to build the quality of life for employees. This characteristic of the community may help a company attract and retain employees as well as encouraging new businesses to locate in the community and further develop the economic base (Rabianski, DeLisle & Cam, 2001).

EXERCISE 2

This exercise is based on nature. The instructor directs the students to write down the name of a flower for each letter of the alphabet (e.g., A = azalea, B = black-eyed Susan, C = chrysanthemum, and so on). Or, instead of flowers, the students could use trees, birds, or any animals. The exercise is equally effective with plants or animals or a combination of each.

When the time for working on this exercise has ended, the instructor can ask students to call out the items they have listed for letters. The class can go through the entire alphabet, or the instructor can call out select letters and find out how many different items can be listed for each. Students often find it interesting to know what items have been identified for less commonly used letters such as Q, X, or Z. It can add to the richness of the exercise if students have chosen a variety of lists, such as flowers, trees, or animals. One of the ways this exercise ties to entrepreneurship is that businesses such as landscaping, lawn maintenance, plant nurseries, fishing guides, outfitters, or pick-your-own farms (e.g., strawberries, apples, blueberries) are built

around nature.

Suppliers for these businesses with products such as seeds for plants, fertilizer, rakes, shovels, bird seed, lawn mowers, fishing poles, tents, camping stoves, and many others also offer viable business opportunities. Florists, nurseries, and home improvement stores sell plants, and pet stores sell animals.

Thinking of plants and animals as products raises the issue of perishability and time sensitivity of inventory. The importance of these issues in the design of the supply chain can be noted. Businesses that sell plants and foods as gifts have unique delivery considerations.

Examples of such businesses that can be shown in class include 1-800-Flowers (www.1800flowers.com), Harry and David (www.harryanddavid.com), Williams-Sonoma (www.williams-sonoma.com), or Figis (www.figis.com). Adding to the complexity of estimating inventory and planning on-time delivery is that many gifts of this type are tied to holidays or other occasions with deadlines such as birthdays or graduations. Also illustrative of the delivery challenges of plants or food are

businesses that ship fresh food such as lobster (www.thelobsterguy.com, www.lobsterstogo.com) or meats by mail (www.omahasteaks.com, www.kansascitysteaks.com).

This exercise can be used to illustrate the constraints on business arising from regulations and the need to be aware of regulations as entrepreneurs manage the risk of their business and estimate the size of their market. There are products related to nature that cannot be sold or that cannot be sold in or shipped to certain places. In the context of nature, there are restrictions on the sale of animals, particularly exotic animals, and bans on trafficking in endangered species. In the United States, there are restrictions on which plants can be sold in which states, in efforts to reduce the threats of non-native, invasive species against native and, perhaps, endangered plants. There are restrictions simply on transporting plant material into some states because of the pests that may bring with them that could damage crops. States regulate the use of wetlands and waterways to protect fragile environments.

Students may offer many interesting examples of

their own if they have ever tried to cross a state or national border with fruit or been on fishing vacations where they encountered equipment restrictions. In the gift businesses mentioned above (e.g., Harry and David, Figis), another example is available in that gifts including bottles of wine cannot be shipped into all of the 50 states. Some states have laws preventing the shipment of bottles of wine to individual recipient's addresses. The catalog order forms and websites for gift basket companies will note these restrictions.

Nature can serve as the inspiration or source of ideas for innovations. For example, the Crabster is a robot the size of a car that was designed to explore the ocean floor using the same type of movements as real crabs (Hsu, 2014a). The Crabster participated during the search and recovery efforts following the South Korean ferry wreck that occurred in April 2014 (Hsu, 2014b).

Prompted by their observations of the behavior of squirrels, researchers are building robots that can learn to be deceptive. Squirrels will implement deceptive movements when patrolling their food stashes in order to lead other animals away from

those stashes and toward fake, empty locations. Robots are being built to mimic this behavior so that they can protect valuable caches of resources (Hicks, 2012). This research also draws on the bluffing behavior demonstrated by some birds. Robots are being built to fly using techniques observed in the flight of bats (Boyle, 2014).

The instructor could make this a longer exercise in creativity by distributing elements of the outdoors, such as rocks, leaves, acorns, flowers, tree bark, sand, and others to the students. Pictures of scenes from nature – such as waterfalls, mountains, beaches, or various animals – could be shown or recordings of sounds from nature could be played.

The instructor would ask the students to identify features of the elements of nature that could inspire new product ideas. The instructor can prompt the students' thinking by pointing out that the items have shape, texture, color, or pattern. For example, inspiration for paint colors or fabric patterns is often drawn from nature. Wall art is often based on stylized pictures of leaves, flowers, or animals.

EXERCISE 3

This exercise is based on games. The instructor directs the students to list as many games as they can. The instructor can give a time limit (such as two minutes) or simply call time when students' writing slows down. If the students ask for clarifying details such as which types of games should be included or how many games are required, the instructor should respond that all of the instructions have been given and that the students should do their best with the instructions as stated.

Once the instructor calls an end to the students' work in listing games, the games can be listed on the board. As students call out the games they have listed, the instructor will likely find that the games fall into several categories such as video or computer games, board games (e.g., Monopoly, Chutes and Ladders), card games (e.g. Hearts, Go Fish), outdoor children's games (e.g., capture the flag, freeze tag), and sports (e.g., football, baseball, basketball).

The first concept related to entrepreneurship that can be tied to this exercise is tolerance for ambiguity. The instructions were given to "create

a list of games" but no details were specified about how many games or which categories of games. The presentation of the instructions is an example of ambiguity because the instructions were open to several different interpretations. An ability to deal with ambiguity and methods for handling ambiguity are relevant in entrepreneurship because entrepreneurs are confronted by much information and noise in the environment. Characteristics such as a tolerance for ambiguity and ambiguity aversion have been identified as factors affecting the success of entrepreneurial ventures (Ng, 2013; Teoh & Foo, 1997).

In trying to complete this exercise even though there were some unanswered questions about the exact steps to follow, the students have brief experience with the feeling of working through ambiguity.

The instructor can also ask students to think back over not only how they processed the ambiguity of the assignment (or if they even perceived ambiguity in the assignment) but also their brainstorming process. After seeing the categories listed on the board, students may realize that

they had thought of a category but dismissed it and did not go further with that part of the list. Perhaps they got focused on one category and could not divert to any others. These reactions that limit the direction of thinking can hinder efforts at problem-solving and the search for alternatives. Entrepreneurs may engage in brainstorming to identify possible alternatives for products or for solving process, design, or market problems. Research into and guidelines for brainstorming have demonstrated that there are ways to improve the effectiveness of brainstorming and that there are behaviors and cognitive approaches that can limit its effectiveness (Brainstorming, 2014; Dugosh, Paulus, Roland & Yang, 2000).

This exercise can also be used to illustrate the complexities of defining your business's competition when you are starting a new business. If you consider that customers are looking to spend money for entertainment, then any of the game alternatives the students have listed might meet that need. For example, manufacturers of board games should consider that it is not only other board games that will offer the entertainment, amusement, challenge,

or past-time that consumers are looking for. Products other than games can meet these needs, too, such as books or movies. Other games that may have been listed by students are also played on a professional level, such as football or basketball. From a business perspective, the competition for National Football League teams is not just other football teams but any other event on which customers might choose to spend their sports entertainment dollars instead. Understanding the choices customers are making when they contemplate spending money on your product or service can help you understand how to market and how to position your business relative to competition.

Another interesting connection between the games and entrepreneurship is the concept of user-driven innovation. New product ideas and product improvements may be generated by the users of a product rather than the manufacturer/seller. Users identify shortcomings in the performance of the current product design while they are using it to accomplish some purpose. Particularly in the context of equipment used in sports competitions, the participants may design a modification that improves the

equipment's performance and, thus, the competitor's chances of winning the sporting event. Research into user-driven innovation examined the context of kayak rodeo or cycling, for example (Franke & Shah, 2003; Hienerth, 2006).

The innovation is driven by lead users who identify a potential improvement and prove that it works through using it in practice. A business sees the market potential in the improvement and scales up production. The equipment associated with games can be a source of business opportunities. An entrepreneur does not have to design a new game but, instead, can create a profitable business by developing equipment for games. The notion that customers may be using a business's games or related equipment in active pursuits introduces an element of risk for the business.

This exercise can be used to draw students' attention to the risk associated with how the business's products will be used. The products used in some games (e.g., lawn darts, baseballs and bats, equipment for swimming pool games) can potentially cause injury and are, therefore, a

source of liability. Entrepreneurs should pay particular attention to the ways their products can be misused and result in additional, unexpected liability. Anticipating the ways customers might use the products and labeling them properly will be important. Video games, too, must be labeled to indicate the levels of violence, language, and other elements that are not appropriate for customers of all ages.

TRAIN YOUR MIND TO WIN THE GAME OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP WITH THESE FOUR MENTAL EXERCISES

Taking the plunge from full-time employee to business owner is no small feat. To move from a stable job with a steady income to one where uncertainty is the flavor of the day every day takes courage, competence and confidence. Most of all, it requires an emotional tolerance strong enough to deal with the pressures of change and unpredictability, not to mention the mental fortitude to navigate through it.

As an entrepreneur, you now wear myriad hats you previously didn't, such as accountant,

marketer, product developer, salesperson and the dreaded small-business taxpayer. As your own boss, there's significantly more pressure to manage, stress to deal with and bills to pay, and if you don't succeed, you fail -- hard. Conversely, as an employee, your focus is more myopic as you hone in on your specialty that defines your job role, such as accountant, restaurateur or cowboy (hey, why not?).

Fortunately, there are mental games you can employ to give yourself an edge. Here are four of them:

1. Breathe, but be smart about it.

Some targets we chased in the SEAL Teams were juicier than others. The likelihood of getting into a gunfight or dealing with otherwise non-compliant customers was greater for some than it was for others. When we knew this, my heart rate would beat faster than normal once we moved to our set point (the final point prior to making entry in the building), so I made a concerted effort to lower it to quell my nerves.

It looked like this: inhale for four seconds, hold for four seconds, exhale for four seconds, hold for four seconds. What this does is help you self-regulate and focus on your breathing rather than the pressure of the moment.

2. Answer your questions.

Playing the "what if?" game is a recipe for self-defeat -- you become your own worst enemy. If fear of the unknown has you tied down, try this: after you find yourself posing the "what if?" question to yourself, answer it. That's right, answer the question.

By doing so you bring that unknown fear into reality and make it more tangible and certain. With certainty comes clarity and with clarity comes opportunity to crush all challenges.

3. Avoid "yes" or "no."

Ask yourself open-ended questions that cause your brain to explore. Developing greater depth and breadth of thought are precursors to genius

(not really, but it makes sense, right?). The mind is a powerful thing. It will find the answer to any question you ask it.

Replace closed-ended questions that begin with a "Do … ?," "Are … ?" or "Have … ?" with open-ended questions that start with "What … ?" or "How … ?" For instance, rather than asking, "Did you have fun at the Halo tournament in Vegas last week?" you can try, "What about the Halo tournament did you enjoy?" The former closes yourself off to exploration while the latter keeps exploring.

4. Find an accountability partner.

It's easy to let goals slip away if you're not held accountable, but when you enlist the support of others to hold you to daily progress, you're more likely to actually follow through with them. I know what you're thinking: "Well, I'll enlist my buddy's support when I have a plan." That's not the point. By then it's too late.

The point is to garner the attention of someone who can hold you accountable to initiate behavior

you wouldn't otherwise take, because if you already have a plan, then all that's left is to check the boxes.

The good news about mastering the mental game is that it's all up to you. You decide just how far you're willing to push yourself based on the purpose and passion that propel you. To make it easier, choose one of the above exercises and employ it for a week. Track your progress.

Gauge where you are at the end of the week and decide whether to continue on with that exercise or try a new one. Either way, you're training the mind to win

CONCLUSIONS

The new general career interventions involving construction, deconstruction, reconstruction and co-construction, lead to action in the real world. The paradigm of designing life does not replace but rather takes a higher position next to vocational guidance and career education paradigms. There are 5 sets of distinctions that differentiate between vocational guidance, education career and life design: actor, agent and author (McAdams and Olson, 2010), object, subject and project (Savickas, 2011b) reassembly, training, and reflexivity (Savickas, 2011) scores, stages and stories (Savickas, 2011a) and features, specifications and themes (Savickas, 2001).

In terms of individual differences, vocational guidance objectively sees actors as actors that can be characterized by scores on different traits

that can be assisted to match the occupations offered by employees. Career education in terms of subjective individual development sees customers as agents that can be characterized by their degree of readiness to engage developmental tasks appropriate for their life stage and can be helped to implement new attitudes, beliefs and skills. Life design from the perspective of social constructivism sees clients as authors can be characterized by their autobiographical stories and can be assisted in reflecting on life themes in build their careers.

Depending on customers' needs and the social, career practitioners can apply interventions that reflect different paradigms: vocational guidance to identify occupational matching, career education to house vocational development or life design to build a career. Each paradigm for career interventions: modernity guidance, late modernity or post-modernity education design is valuable

and effective for its intended purpose. Special attention is given to Chaos Theory in Career development.

The Chaos Theory of Careers (CTC) characterizes individuals as complex systems subject to the influence of complex influences and chance events. In time, patterns emerge in individual's behaviour that is self-similar but also subject to change. Career trajectories/ histories/ stories are examples of such complex fractal patterns.

Careers are subject to non linear change – sometimes small steps have profound outcomes, and sometimes changing everything changes nothing. Careers are also unpredictable, with most people expressing a degree of surprise/ delight or disappointment at where they ended up. Thus, careers are subject to continual change. Sometimes individuals experience slow shift (Bright, 2008) that results in drifting off course without realizing it, and sometimes careers have

dramatic (fast shift) changes which completely turn everything upside down.

Careers take shape and exhibit self-similar patterns, trajectories, traits, narratives, preoccupations over time. Individuals and careers are too complex to be easily captured and put into simple boxes, interest or personality codes.

Constructivism proposes that individuals are pattern makers; people can find connections and structure in almost any stimuli. The heart of CTC is represented by the idea of emergent patterns.

In seeking to understand these exceedingly complex and ever changing patterns individuals will construct meaning from experiences of these patterns (Pryor & Bright, 2003).

In summary, CTC and any counselling process based upon it will have to take into account the following concepts:

- ✓ Change – Bright (2008), Jepson & Chouduri (2001),

- ✓ Chance – Chen (2005), Krumboltz & Levin (2006); Bright et al (2005), Bright, Pryor & Harpham (2005),
- ✓ Complexity – Patton & McMahon (2006); Lent, Brown & Hacket (1996); Bright et al (2005),
- ✓ Fractal patterns – Bright & Pryor (2010); Bright & Pryor (2005); Bloch (2005); Savickas et al (2009),
- ✓ Emergence — Pryor & Bright (2004); Bright & Pryor (2010); Morrowitz (2003),
- ✓ Attractors — Pryor & Bright (2007); Bright & Pryor (2005),
- ✓ Constructivism — Savickas (1997); Savickas et al (2009),

The Chaos Theory of Careers (CTC) helps reduce clients' fears of failing by exploring the reasons behind their fears, such as through „failure questioning" in which they imagine how their lives would be should they really fail (Pryor & Bright, 2012). This approach increases clients' comfort

with uncertainties by helping them reframe mistakes and failures as a necessary part of reality and an opportunity for learning.

Narrative career counselling has emerged as a viable future response to career counselling client's complex needs. This handbook presents theoretical and practical arguments for narrative career counselling's contribution, through storytelling, in providing a meaningful experience for career counselling clients.

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